KASPAROV KORCHNOI

THE LONDON CONTEST



RAYMOND KEENE & DOMINIC LAWSON

Acorn Computer World Chess Championship



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Kasparov-Korchnoi

The London Contest

RAYMOND KEENE
DOMINIC LAWSON

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To Annette and Jane

A BATSFORD CHESS BOOK
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CONFLICT
Dominic Lawson

This book is about the second Korchnoi-Kasparov match to take place in 1983. The first one started and finished on Saturday 6 August. At one o'clock that afternoon Viktor Korchnoi walked up to a chess table in a deserted auditorium in Pasadena, USA, pushed his queen's pawn two squares forward, and started his invisible opponent's clock. An hour later, the lonely pawn still staring at the undisturbed black army, Korchnoi was declared winner of the match against Gary Kasparov – by forfeit.

The abandonment of the most eagerly awaited chess match since the 1972 clash between Bobby Fischer and Boris Spassky caused an anguish throughout the chess world, already deeply wounded by the premature retirement of the genius from Brooklyn. But unlike Fischer's abdication, this crisis had seemed so unnecessary, so avoidable. How had it come about? And how could it be resolved?

The Candidates' matches for the right to challenge World Champion Anatoly Karpov started life as they were destined to continue – contentiously. At the drawing of lots in November 1982 at the Lucerne Congress of the *Fédération Internationale des Echecs* ('FIDE', the World Chess Federation), the following pairings were created:

1. Hübner-Smyslov
2. Ribli-Torre
3. Korchnoi-Portisch
4. Belyavsky-Kasparov

In the semi-final round the winner of match 1 would play the winner of match 2, and the winner of match 3 would play the winner of match 4. It was already evident that something had gone very wrong. With the exception of the West German Grandmaster Robert Hübner, all the favourites were bunched in the second half of the

draw. However, things looked even odder when the venerable Vasily Smyslov, World Champion in 1957, beat Hübner at roulette. They had tried chess first, but as neither player could be induced to win the match, the gaming equivalent of tossing a coin was employed. On the first spin of the wheel, using a solid gold ball, zero came up. On the second spin of the wheel the prayers of the religiously inclined Soviet, who put his faith in 'red', worked better than the guesswork of the West German. So Smyslov won the right to play the diffident and quietly spoken Hungarian Zoltan Ribli, who had dispatched the Philippines' most famous sportsman, Eugenio Torre.

The match between the two qualifiers from the Moscow Interzonal, Kasparov and Belyavsky, took place in the same city in March 1983. Kasparov, by now rated second only to Karpov, crashed through the defences of the Lvov player to win 6-3. Viktor Korchnoi, meanwhile, shook off his atrocious form of the previous year, and crushingly beat the psychologically frail Hungarian Lajos Portisch.

The impending clash between Kasparov and Korchnoi would clearly attract record bids for a Candidates' Semi-Final match. A contest between the most exciting player since Fischer and the virulently anti-Soviet defector Korchnoi (otherwise known as 'The Leningrad Lip') would be a fantastic boost for any national Chess Federation which managed to stage the event. But who would come up with the minimum FIDE prize fund of Sw. Fr. 25,000 to host the Smyslov-Ribli match, when it was universally agreed that neither of them would give any trouble to the ultimate victor of the collision between Korchnoi and Kasparov?

Bids for the two matches had to be lodged with FIDE by 15 May. When the deadline expired three offers had been received: (1) from the United States Chess Federation (USCF), with Pasadena, California as the venue and a prize fund of Sw. Fr. 100,000; (2) from the Royal Dutch Chess Federation (KNSB) with Rotterdam as the venue and a prize fund also of Sw. Fr. 100,000; (3) from the Spanish Chess Federation, offering Las Palmas as a site and a prize fund of Sw. Fr. 25,000.

To no one's surprise there were no bids for the Smyslov-Ribli match. Even the federations of the two players, which by FIDE regulations should then have submitted their own offers, failed to show any interest. Then, on 1 June, only a couple of months before the matches were due to start, the President of FIDE, Florencio Campomanes, announced that a *deus ex machina* in the unlikely form

of the United Arab Emirates Chess Federation had offered a prize fund of Sw. Fr. 25,000 and Abu Dhabi as a site for the unwanted Semi-Final. This was widely seen as a personal coup for Campomanes, whose power base in FIDE was the third world and so-called 'developing' chess nations.

Do you know Florencio B. Campomanes? A 56-year-old Filipino, he was Deputy President of FIDE for eight years before winning a four-year term as President in 1982. He won the election of the General Assembly on the second ballot on 17 November, beating the existing President, the Icelandic Grandmaster Fridrik Olafsson, by 65 votes to 43. The three Dutch members of the FIDE Secretariat, including the General Secretary Ineke Bakker, had threatened to resign if Campomanes were elected, and they duly did so.

Campomanes is a strong chess player (he was captain of the Philippines national team for 24 years), but more importantly he is a skilful and tough politician, and a former assistant to his friend, former President Garcia. It is believed that Campomanes gained much of his funds for his successful presidential campaign by playing blackjack. Campomanes has a reputation as a gambler, for which his inscrutable Asiatic countenance is a considerable asset.

Campomanes' announcement on 1 June of the Abu Dhabi bid for Smyslov-Ribli was unexpected, but it was completely overshadowed by the rest of his announcement:

> I HAVE DECIDED TO AWARD ORGANISATION OF CANDIDATES' SEMI-FINAL KASPAROV-KORCHNOI MATCH TO UNITED STATES CHESS FEDERATION

That statement started a war of words between FIDE and the mighty USSR Chess Federation that promised to split the chess world as surely as if the Berlin Wall itself had come down in the thickly carpeted office of the FIDE President.

The Soviet Chess Federation's response to Campomanes' awarding of the Korchnoi-Kasparov match to Pasadena, as the first of a veritable avalanche of telexes that were to be sent from Moscow, is worth reprinting in full:

> 2.06.83. ATTENTION MR CAMPOMANES URGENT. YOUR DECISION ON JUNE 1 TO APPOINT PASSADENA AS VENUE FOR THE SEMI FINAL CANDIDATES MATCH KASPAROV KORCHNOI CONTRADICTS TO POINT 7,32 OF THE REGULATIONS FOR THESE COMPETITIONS.

BOTH PARTICIPANTS IN THEIR OFFFICIAL REPLIES NAMED ROTTERDAM AND NOT PASSADENU. THE FACT THAT ONE OF THE PARTICIPANTS PLACED ROTTERDAM FIRST AND THE OTHER ONE PLACED IT SECOND IS OF NO IMPORTANCE. THE SIMILAR SITUATION WAS IN 1978 WHEN BOTH PARTICIPANTS DIDNT PLACE BAGIO FIRST AND IT WAS CHOSEN FOR THE MATCH AS THE ONLY ONE COINCIDED IN THE LISTS. AS FAR AS THE WEATHER CONDITIONS ARE CONCERNED THAT MUST BE TAKEN INTO CONSIDERATION ACCORDING TO P.7.32, AUGUST IS MORE FAVOURABLE IN ROTTERDAM THAN IN PASSADENU. WE MAKE A PROTEST AGAINST YOUR DECISION AND INSIST ON ITS RECONSIDERATION. REGARDS USSR CHESS FEDERATION

In its account of the players' official choices at least, the Moscow missive was correct. Korchnoi had let it be known that he favoured Rotterdam. As he had defected in Holland and plays for Volmac, a Dutch chess club, that was no surprise. Kasparov had chosen Las Palmas first, and Rotterdam second. The cynic would say that Las Palmas was on his list because, with its measly prize fund, it could attract only a Soviet chess player enjoying state support. But it is also a major port of call for Soviet ships. Korchnoi would not have considered Las Palmas for a second. But Rotterdam had its attractions for the Soviets too. There is a thriving Russian community there nourished by the oil market and the flow of Soviet products through the port.

The USSR Chess Federation's recollection of the events of 1978 was germane: the decision of the then president, Dr Max Euwe, to hold the World Championship between Korchnoi and Karpov in Baguio City in the Philippines had caused protests from both players. But Dr Euwe overruled the protests, pointing out that Baguio had at least been the second choice of both participants.

But the Soviets were on dangerous ground in drawing analogies between World Championship matches and Candidates' matches. The rules for the events are not identical, and lay subtly different stresses on the extent that players' wishes should be observed.

The Soviet Chess Federation's basic argument that Campomanes' decision had infringed Rule 7.32 of the FIDE regulations for Candidates' matches is critical to their case. What is the mysterious rule?

Rule 7.3 of the 'Specific regulations for the men's and the ladies'

candidates matches' approved by the 1980 FIDE General Assembly is: 'The General Assembly will decide which Federations are entitled to organise the Candidates matches. Between the annual meetings the President will decide'. The all important 7.32 continues: 'When choosing the venue the conditions, the propaganda effects, the climate and the wishes of the participants shall be taken into consideration'.

The rules for the individual World Championship match clearly put the players' wishes first, rather than fourth as in the case of Candidates' matches.

Campomanes was so convinced that the USSR Chess Federation had simply misinterpreted the rules that he immediately replied to the Soviet telex with one of his own:

2 JUNE 1983 REPLYING YOUR TELEX TODAY ON MY DECISION ON KORCHNOI KASPAROV MATCH KINDLY READ AGAIN POINT 7.32 OF CANDIDATES REGULATIONS . . . I WISH YOU COULD BRING YOURSELF TO ACCEPT IN GOOD HEART MY DECISION MADE IN THE GENERAL INTEREST OF WORLD CHESS. WITH KIND REGARDS FLORENCIO CAMPOMANES.

It is likely that at this stage some members of the USSR Chess Federation realised that Campomanes had not abused his powers, and was acting constitutionally. But the Soviet diplomatic machine is not programmed to accept a loss of face, and rather than admit its error proceeded to lobby the chess world, in an effort to pressurise Campomanes into reversing his decision.

It is difficult not to have some sympathy for the Soviets. It did seem odd that the President had chosen a site for the match in which neither player had shown any interest. In addition, it can hardly have escaped the Russians that the US Chess Federation had chosen to stage the match in the very place where Bobby Fischer now lives. There must surely have been some hope on the Americans' part that the presence of such a match on Fischer's own front door would have induced the Loch Ness Monster of world chess (often sighted but never seen) to put in an appearance that would raise certain half-forgotten questions about the Soviet domination of world chess.

However, Campomanes' choice of Pasadena had little to do with the faint possibility of inducing Fischer, a personal friend of his, out of an eleven-year hibernation. Pasadena had thrown in with its bid a Sw. Fr. 40,000 donation for FIDE's fund for chess developing

countries, a project dear to Campomanes, who is fond of quoting from the FIDE statutes thus: 'The aim and purpose of FIDE is the diffusion and development of chess among all nations'. That, says Campomanes, is why the Semi-Final matches were assigned to 'non-traditional chess areas'.

But what of the players themselves? For Smyslov and Ribli of course there was no choice. But both Korchnoi and Kasparov were in a key position to influence the outcome of the battle between FIDE and the USSR Chess Federation. (The Soviets insisted all along that their battle was not with FIDE but with Campomanes, a distinction which was naturally endorsed by Campomanes' critics within FIDE.)

On 4 June a telex arrived at the office of the FIDE headquarters. It was from Baku in Soviet Azerbaijan.

MR CAMPOMANES FLORENCIO FIDE CHESS AMSTERDAM HOLLAND. AS KNOWN ANNOUNCEMENT OF PASADENA USA AS PLACE OF MATCH ARISES UNACCEPTABLE CONFLICT SITUATION AS BOTH PLAYERS WISH TO PLAY IN HOLLAND WILL YOU KINDLY MR PRESIDENT NOT OPPOSE INTERESTS OF LEADING GRANDMASTER TO THOSE FOR POPULARIZATION OF CHESS THROUGHOUT THE WORLD INTERNATIONAL GRANDMASTER GARRI KASPAROV

There is no doubt that by this stage Kasparov genuinely wished to play in Holland. But had that always been his position? There are persistent but unconfirmed rumours that he originally was happy with Pasadena, but that he was persuaded against it by his mentor and former tutor, ex-World Champion Mikhail Botvinnik. Certainly a later telex by Kasparov criticising the President's choice of venue is written in a style described by one former pupil of Botvinnik's school of chess as 'pure Botvinnik'.

The American chess player Eric Schiller, who is fluent in Russian, claims to have rung Kasparov in Baku on 9 May, to let him know of the possibility of a match in Pasadena. Schiller says 'he liked our bid, he sounded happy and enthusiastic'. Of course, as an American chess plenipotentiary who would be closely involved in any such match, Schiller would naturally seize on any interest shown by Kasparov. In addition, Schiller is 'Gary's friend' and has collaborated with him on chess books. So was Kasparov just trying to be tactful?

Some support for Schiller's beliefs is contained in a letter sent to Ray Keene by Kasparov:

Dear sir!

I have received your letter, but unfortunately our meeting is to be postponed as, getting ready for the semi-final, I refused to take part in the European Chess Team Championship.

If you have such an opportunity, will you be so kind as to send me all the material available on my future opponent.

. . .

I think I'll meet you at the semifinal match either in Rotterdam or Pasadena (alas, I don't know yet where exactly).

My best regards to your wife.

Sincerely yours
Gary Kasparov

02.06.83
Baku

PS. I do not quite agree with the changes concerning the system of the world champion tournament. Give me all the information on this question you can.

The date of this letter is pregnant with possibilities, being the day after Campomanes made his fateful announcement. It seems certain that at the time he wrote this letter Kasparov did not know of Campomanes' decision. But Kasparov does not even mention his supposed 'first choice', Las Palmas. Clearly he realised that its derisory prize fund ruled it out of all consideration. But significantly, he does not show any preference between the two remaining choices of venue, although in his PS he *is* quite ready to speak out against the new system of world championship matches. If Kasparov was vehemently opposed to the prospect of playing in the US, it seems strange that he did not say so to Keene.

The Swiss Federation accepted Campomanes' decision in a letter received by FIDE on 6 June, but with reservations: 'It seams [sic] to our federation that your interpretation to prefer FIDE's interests to the players wishes is quite different from former decisions, and we would like to have a more detailed representation of your point of view'.

However, Swiss misgivings were rendered redundant when on 8 June Korchnoi himself wired FIDE:

I AM GLAD TO PLAY SEMI FINAL MATCH IN CALIFORNIA. HOPE TO BEGIN WITH ACCLIMATIZATION FROM JULY 18TH VICTOR KORCHNOI.

The match was due to start on 1 August.

At this point the lobbying of national chess federations by the Soviets, and to some extent by Campomanes, began in earnest. Soviet Embassies and Consulates all over the world played host to bemused chess functionaries, including the British Chess Federation's President Peter Shaw, who found himself sipping cognac with the Soviet Ambassador in Kensington. To no avail: On 22 July FIDE General Secretary Lim Kok Ann read:

BCF HAS NO OBJECTION TO FIDE CHOICE OF VENUES CANDIDATES SEMI FINAL AND EXPRESSES SUPPORT. SIGNED SHAW PRESIDENT BRITISH CHESS FEDERATION.

By the time that Shaw's message of support had arrived relations between Campomanes and the USSR had further deteriorated. On his way from Zürich to Tunis, Campomanes had received an urgent request from the USSR Chess Federation to meet Gramov, the new Soviet Sports Minister, in Moscow.

The flying visit, of only 12 hours, on 12 July, was a disaster. According to Campomanes, he was told that Smyslov would agree to play in Abu Dhabi if the idea of a Korchnoi-Kasparov match in Pasadena was dropped. Campomanes was intensely irritated by this crude piece of horse trading, but was even more put out when Gramov (through an interpreter who should have known better) snarled: 'Campomanes, you serve the Americans well!'. The Soviet Sports Minister had at least good reason to assume that the Hungarian Chess Federation would fall into line with any trade-off he could negotiate with Campomanes. It is believed that earlier he had summoned the head of the Hungarian Sports Council to Moscow and told him that Ribli was on no account to 'agree' to play in Abu Dhabi.

It was at around this time that the USSR began to make some fatal tactical errors. While their position was simply that of supporting the rights of top players against the desire of Campomanes to propagate chess worldwide, they had the support of many top players. The Soviet Chess Federation might have lost the technical battle over the exact meaning of Candidates' matches regulations, but it was felt by many not in the Soviet camp that if a match could legitimately be held in a venue not selected by either of the players, then those regulations should be changed.

But that strength in the Soviet position was completely undermined when the USSR Chess Federation was so openly

ɔared to use Smyslov, the venerable ex-World Champion, as a pawn in their battle with Campomanes. The USSR Chess Federation's subsequent complaint that the temperatures of up to 50 degrees Celsius in Abu Dhabi could wreck the health of their veteran star therefore aroused scant sympathy.

On 15 July, only three days after the abortive Moscow meeting, the USSR Chess Federation produced an entirely new argument but one which many thought was the real reason for their intransigence:

15.07.83 ATTENTION MR F CAMPOMANES FIDE PRESIDENT.
DEAR MR F CAMPOMANES, THE USSR CHESS FEDERATION CONFIRMS THE PROTEST EARLIER SENT TO FIDE CONCERNING THE ORGANISATION OF SEMI FINAL CANDIDATES MATCHES IN PASADENA AND ABU-DHABI. DUE TO VIOLATIONS MADE BY FIDE IN THIS MATTER AND LIMITATION IN TIME FOR FINDING A SOLUTION, WHICH IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE FIDE REGULATIONS WILL TAKE INTO ACCOUNT THE OPINIONS AND WISHES OF THE PARTICIPANTS WE PROPOSE TO POSTPONE THE BEGINNING OF THE SEMIFINAL MATCHES. WHEN CHOOSING LAS PALMAS AND ROTTERDAM FOR PLAYING THE MATCH G.KASPAROV HAS HAD IN MIND THE FACT THAT THERE ARE NO NORMAL CONDITIONS IN PASADENA FOR PLAYING THE MATCH, IN PARTICULAR THERE ARE NO GOVERNMENTAL GUARANTEES OF SECURITY AND FREE ENTRANCE TO PASADENA FOR SOVIET REPRESENTATIVES AND DIPLOMATS. REGARDS. THE USSR CHESS FEDERATION.

Campomanes exulted when he heard the Soviet admission that they were worried about Pasadena because it was off limits to Soviet diplomats and officials: 'At last the cat was out of the bag!'. Among Western commentators too the feeling was that the USSR had only now given its true reason for rejecting Pasadena. Certainly most of the English press took the attitude that Kasparov would defect if he was exposed for a month to the delights of a Californian life-style.

If this version is remotely accurate then the Russian treatment of Kasparov while he was in London is mystifying. He was frequently seen coming and going from the Great Eastern hotel, with only his two grandmaster assistants for company. I myself was perfectly free, on the day after Kasparov arrived in London, to share an aperitif with the young genius in the Tower Hotel. And immediately afterwards Max Hastings came up, in order to interview Gary.

Max Hastings' own report in the next day's *Standard* shows how much the 'defection' theory had built up preconceptions:

I suppose it is a shocking indictment of those of us who watch too many late-night Ronald Reagan speeches and have been brainwashed by years of reading the Tory Central Office version of Pravda, *to say that I had never expected to see Kasparov alone. Reporting to the crowded restaurant of the Tower Hotel, where the great meeting of Titans was being launched, I rather expected to find the visiting star flanked by a team of stony-faced minders from the Soviet Embassy.*

Instead, after a brisk introduction to the young man with a shock of black hair, sitting at one of the tables, I was told that we should be left on our own. Suddenly rather conscious that Russian was not on the curriculum of my school, I asked anxiously where the interpreter was. No interpreter, they said, Kasparov speaks pretty OK English for himself.

As Max Hastings pointed out later in his piece, 'The Black and White of being the best in the world', when an interpreter did become necessary, it was an American friend of Kasparov's who did the translating.

The Soviets' argument that Pasadena is in the Los Angeles area, and thus a closed city to Soviet diplomats and consular officials, was in any case not strictly accurate. The US Chess Federation President, Timothy Redman, on hearing of the Soviet objections took the matter up with the State Department, and on 19 July received the following reply:

Dear Mr Redman,

In this case Soviet officials should have discussed their concerns with the Department of State or with our Embassy in Moscow. I have checked with our Embassy in Moscow and can assure you that as I write we have not been approached either in Moscow or in Washington. In fact we are still waiting for the team to submit its visa applications.

The United States does apply restrictions on the travel of Soviet diplomatic and consular personnel in reciprocity for controls placed on our people in the USSR. Pasadena is, however, in an area open to Soviet travel. To register travel to Pasadena, a Soviet official would have to file a travel notification 48 hours in advance. In the case of a real emergency requiring the presence in Pasadena of a Soviet official we would be ready to consider a request to shorten the notification period. Sincerely, B Morton, Deputy Director for Exchanges, Office of Soviet Union Affairs.

Finally, as Campomanes himself noted to the USSR Chess Federation, the Soviet swimmer Vladimir Salnikov was in the process of breaking the 800 metres freestyle world record in a swimming meet in Los Angeles, California, 'in the same week we were discussing this matter in Moscow'.

Despite the great significance attached to Soviets' anxiety about security in the Western press, it seems more plausible that the USSR Chess Federation, having lost the technical 'rule book' argument with Campomanes, was now willing to bring up any argument, however tenuous, as a reason for not playing in Pasadena. Sensing the weakening of the Soviet position, Campomanes, through the FIDE deputy president Roman Toran, summoned a special meeting of the FIDE Executive Council, to discuss and vote on the question of the Candidates' venues. Ironically, this meeting had also been sought by the Soviet side, in the mistaken belief that they would win on a show of hands. It was to take place in Madrid on 29-30 July, only a week before the rescheduled start of the matches. This was in part a device by Campomanes to enable the USSR to give way without losing face. For it seemed certain that the council would endorse what was the official FIDE position. Of the 13 members of the Council, only Krogius of the USSR and Jimenez of Cuba were likely to adopt a stance of outright opposition to Campomanes.

In fact Krogius and Campomanes got into something of a brawl. The minutes record that the deputy president for Asia, Dato Tan Chin Nam, 'urged Mr Campomanes and Dr Krogius to let off steam at the chessboard and come back amicably to the conference table'.

The executive council duly voted on the motion: 'The Council after thorough discussion accepts and affirms Candidates' matches Regulation 7.3 fully empowers President to decide venues of Pasadena and Abu Dhabi'. The voting was 8-2 in favour, with three abstentions. Campomanes' idea may have been that now the USSR Chess Federation could give way, albeit under protest, on the grounds that it had been outvoted on the Executive Council.

This might have happened, but the very next day, 31 July, the Abu Dhabi organisers suddenly withdrew their offer to stage the match. It is believed that they were enraged by the Russians' objections to the

climatic conditions, as if Abu Dhabi had not yet discovered air conditioning. And as Campomanes pointed out, 'the Russians did not even acknowledge the receipt of the invitation telex, not even a "Thank you" nor a "We shall let you know later". After enduring this discourtesy for two months, the UAE withdrew their offer'.

Having had their position apparently strengthened by Campo's reverse in the Gulf, the USSR now prepared to meet the President head on at the forthcoming FIDE congress, due to take place in Manila in October. There the Soviets hoped to destroy Campomanes by carrying a vote of censure against him. They had a 16-vote block of tame chess federations, mostly from Eastern Europe, and Greece and Iceland had already voiced support for the Soviet position.

By 9 August Kasparov and Smyslov had been duly defaulted, and FIDE declared Korchnoi and Ribli the winners of their respective 'matches'. Naturally Campomanes wanted to organise a Korchnoi-Ribli match as soon as possible, in order to present Congress with a *fait accompli.*

Korchnoi himself in an interview in the August edition of the US magazine *Players' Chess News* said 'the situation is rather unclear but there is a chance I will play Ribli in one or two months. For my part I am ready to play such a match'. And Ribli? He was in touch with Campomanes to arrange a flight out of Hungary, in order to discuss and arrange a match with Korchnoi:

> 10.8.83 ATT MR FLORENCIO CAMPOMANES, I HAVE ACCEPTED YOUR DECISION OF AUGUST 9 ON THE SMYSLOV-RIBLI CANDIDATES SEMI FINAL MATCH. PLEASE INFORM ME WHERE AND WHEN DO I HAVE TO PLAY AGAINST KORCHNOI IN THE CANDIDATES FINAL MATCH. THE ABOVE CABLE HAS BEEN FORWARDED TO HUNGARIAN CHESS FEDERATION ALSO, REGARDS ZOLTAN RIBLI.

Ribli's desire to keep his Federation informed had one immediate consequence: his right to foreign travel was promptly withdrawn.

So Campomanes was stymied. But in any event, a Korchnoi-Ribli match would have been without credibility as a Candidates' Final. Aside from the method of reaching it, Korchnoi had, with the exception of his match with Portisch, a very bad run of results, and Ribli was not taken seriously as a contender for the World Championship. And would the Soviets ever accede to a World Championship match between Korchnoi and Karpov, assuming

that Ribli's Government continued to prevent him leaving Hungary? Inconceivable. Campomanes has said that, if Karpov refused to play such a match, then he would have declared Bobby Fischer World Champion (!!) and set up a match between Fischer and Korchnoi. Campomanes described this as his fall-back position, but it seems more like the purest manifestation of sang-froid, in the face of the Soviet onslaught. Aside from the complete unconstitutionality of such a move, Campomanes should know, if anyone should, the problems involved in getting the American recluse even to discuss such a possibility. Campomanes had tried for six years to arrange a match between Fischer and Karpov, then a match between Fischer and anyone, in both cases with singular lack of success.

At this juncture,with Campomanes appealing to national chess federations, 'Please come to my succour in this confrontation with the behemoth that is the Soviet Chess Federation!', it is worth an attempt to clear up a still unanswered question: why *was* the USSR Chess Federation so violently opposed to Pasadena? It is not necessarily the case that the USSR Chess Federation was united in this opposition. But the politically appointed Vice-President of the Federation, Dr Krogius, was unremittingly hostile to Campomanes' choice of venue, and that was sufficient to determine the Federation's policy.

There is a theory that the rejection of Pasadena represented a dry run for a boycott of the Los Angeles Olympic Games, due to take place next year. But that is all it is – a theory, with no supporting facts. The 'Kasparov defection' concept, though almost universally believed in the West, is inconsistent, as we have seen, with events in London.

We have also looked at the theory that Kasparov was happy to play in Pasadena until his mentor Botvinnik advised him against it. That theory is not pooh-poohed in the USSR itself. But first, Kasparov is a very independent-minded young man, by no means in the thrall of the cantankerous ex-World Champion. Second, even if he had been persuaded by Botvinnik, that would not constitute a reason for the USSR Chess Federation to act as it did. Botvinnik is hardly *persona grata* in the governing body of Soviet chess. Indeed he has not been seen inside the walls of the Central Chess Club for five years.

Viktor Korchnoi himself believes that the match was stymied by the Soviets because 'Kasparov is not well liked by his political

superiors', and, because Kasparov could well wrest the world crown from the politically pure Karpov: 'the Soviets would prefer even me as the Candidate instead of Kasparov'.

Korchnoi, in an interview with *Players' Chess News*, added that the Soviet boycott of Pasadena 'is largely Karpov's doing. It is evident that Karpov and Kasparov dislike each other . . . Karpov led the Soviets on telling them that Campomanes would back down eventually, all the time knowing Campo well enough to realise that he wouldn't back down'. This theory of Korchnoi probably says more about him than it does about Karpov. Campomanes insists that Karpov was primarily instrumental in urging the USSR Chess Federation to reach agreement with FIDE.

There are two sensible explanations for the Soviet actions:

1. The USSR Chess Federation, as we have seen, confused the rules for the Candidates' matches, in which the players' wishes are the fourth of four criteria determining the venues, with the rules for the World Championship match itself, where it is the first consideration. (The Soviets have argued that the crucial rule 7.3 of the Candidates' matches – 'when choosing the venue, the conditions, the propaganda effects, the climate and the wishes of the participants shall be taken into consideration' – is not an ordered list, and hence each criterion is at least of equal importance. Campomanes replies that he did 'take into consideration' each item, but 'what to consider is at his own discretion'.)

But having made a technical error, the Soviets made far too many strongly worded public announcements of their objections ever to back down without considerable public humiliation. Hence, after realising their mistake, they then dragged in other spurious arguments, such as the security factor, in an attempt to sustain their opposition to Pasadena. The chronic aversion to any public admission of error is a fundamental tenet of Soviet diplomatic practice.

2. Campomanes had fought hard for the Candidates' Quarter-Final matches to be held in Spain or Switzerland all together at one and the same time. The Soviet Chess Federation prevented this, insisting, as they were entitled, that the Quarter-Final match between Kasparov and Belyavsky be held under the auspices of the USSR Chess Federation in Moscow. The theory goes on that Campomanes then awarded the Korchnoi-Kasparov match to Pasadena, Fischer's home town, and in Ronald Reagan's home state, as a 'punishment' to the Soviets

for crossing him over the staging of the Quarter-Finals and depriving FIDE of considerable revenue. This belief is widely held in the Soviet Union.

The consequence is that the Soviet Sports Ministry took Campomanes' decision as a personal insult, and one which could not be endured by the greatest chess playing nation on earth.

In this light it is interesting to read Alexander Roshal, the well known Soviet chess commentator, in the 3 August edition of *Sovietsky Sport*:

It is wrong to insist that the Kasparov-Korchnoi match should be held in the USA. The President's attitude to the Grandmasters, members of FIDE, can only be qualified as a policy of diktat. But the Soviet chessplayers have their pride, and this is not only a feature of national character. They have the right to such pride because they have won fifteen out of seventeen European and World titles in competitions conducted by FIDE. By the way, there are many more chessplayers living in the Soviet Union and officially belonging to FIDE than in all other national federations combined.

two
RESOLUTION

In fact the USSR Chess Federation sunk its differences with Campomanes before the Manila Congress in October, although it was not until then that the chess world realised that the rift had been patched up.

The Soviets had taken soundings, and despite their best efforts it should have been clear to them that Campomanes, with his Third World power base, was most likely to survive a Soviet-inspired vote of censure. In the 1982 November Presidential election, the Eastern Europe-backed candidate, Kažić of Yugoslavia, got a paltry 19 votes, against Campomanes' 53. Campomanes may have been playing for high stakes against the Soviet Chess Federation, but, like any good poker player, he had a fair idea of how the aces were distributed.

In mid-August Richard Owen of *The Times* wrote from Moscow that there was a possibility that the Soviet Union could withdraw from FIDE, and form its own 'world federation' controlled by the Soviet block and the Third World. These federations may have given grudging private support when told by Moscow that they might not see any more USSR grandmasters in their countries if they supported Campomanes. But would they actually vote with the Russians in the glare of Congress, in Manila, Campomanes' own backyard?

At the beginning of September a worried Soviet Chess Federation asked Raymond Keene, the BCF delegate to FIDE, to fly to Moscow at Soviet expense, to discuss the situation. Keene got the 10 am flight on Friday 9 September, the last British Airways flight to Moscow out of Heathrow before the pilots shut down the route as a protest against the shooting down of KAL 007.

Keene was met at the airport by Krogius, and then was taken off in a black Zil to the Sports Ministry, where he had a three o'clock meeting with the Deputy Sports Minister, Ivonin. Keene told Ivonin

that the Soviet Chess Federation would lose on a show of hands against Campomanes in Manila, that Moscow's position was constitutionally untenable, and that it would be less embarrassing all round if the Soviets came to some sort of private arrangement with the President.

A couple of days after the meeting with Keene, Ivonin left with an interpreter for Lucerne, where the headquarters of FIDE is situated. It is believed that there, in a Chinese restaurant, Ivonin and Campomanes agreed in principle a means of ending the three and a half month old dispute.

Any worthwhile agreement would have to provide answers to a number of seemingly insoluble questions:

(1) How could Kasparov and Smyslov be allowed back into the Candidates, having been defaulted?

(2) How on earth could Korchnoi and Ribli be induced to play, and risk losing, matches they had already 'won'.

(3) If the Korchnoi-Kasparov match was to be rebid for, who would reimburse the US Chess Federation the $50,000 the Pasadena organisers had sunk in the abortive match?

It must have been some chop suey.

Meanwhile Keene went back to London via Yugoslavia, where the great Nikšić International Tournament was in progress. Present were virtually all the world's top players including Kasparov. Keene summoned a meeting of the FIDE players' council on 10 September, two rounds before the end of the tournament, which Kasparov won by a crushing margin. The competitors, including Soviet grandmasters, put their names to a plea to the forthcoming congress to do 'everything it can to arrange for and organise the Semi-Final matches of the candidates Kasparov-Korchnoi and Ribli-Smyslov'. This declaration was microfilmed by Soviet journalist Roshal, and smuggled out of Nikšić in a matchbox! But much more interesting than this anodyne missive, was the fact that Korchnoi unexpectedly turned up, and warmly embraced all the Soviet players present. Apparently Spassky, who, after his bitter match with Korchnoi in 1977, had not been on spitting terms with the defector,was quite taken aback, but then kissed and made up. Was the seven-year Soviet boycott of Korchnoi at an end? And who or what could have induced the normally unforgiving Viktor to make such a gesture?

Korchnoi then joined the Nikšić competitors in a double-round blitz tournament in Herceg Novi. He lost twice to Kasparov, but the

most interesting encounter between the two players was no chess game but a meeting in a room in the offices of the sponsors (Montenegro Export). Having exchanged expressions of mutual admiration, Korchnoi and Kasparov announced their intention to play a match, despite the fact that officially at least Korchnoi had already won it. Events were running smoothly, as if they had been stage-managed by Ivonin and Campomanes themselves. Korchnoi even called Campomanes from Nikšić, saying 'I'm here, acting as your agent!'.

Korchnoi's agreement not to claim the match against Kasparov by default caused general astonishment. He was by no means favoured to win against Kasparov, but in a final against Ribli he would have been odds-on. Why did Korchnoi spurn such an apparently guaranteed route to a match against Karpov, or even the chance of the world title itself, if Karpov refused to play?

It is true that the chess player in Korchnoi must have been very curious to find out what would happen in a match against Kasparov. And such a match would be very lucrative to the highly professional Viktor. Had the Soviets made some behind the scenes offer to end the boycott if the match took place? The events at Nikšić and Herceg Novi seem more explicable in that light. Even then, however, Korchnoi must have taken some persuading with many sterling reasons. As regards Ribli, his decision to 'replay' Smyslov was essentially made for him by his Federation, who insisted only that the next match should have a prize fund at least equal to that of Abu Dhabi.

The Manila Congress met on 6 October with the Soviet protest regarding the Semi-Final venues the main issue to be debated. But the Soviet Chess Federation withdrew its protest from the agenda almost as soon as the Congress had opened.

The Soviet Chess Federation Chairman, the former cosmonaut Vitaly Sevastianov , just happened to be staying on the same floor, in the same hotel as Campomanes – on the eighth floor of the Manila Regent. It is believed that, in those two suites, Sevastianov hammered out with Campomanes the details of what Ivonin and Campomanes had sketched out on the tablecloth of the Chinese restaurant in Lucerne. The drift of Ivonin's instructions to Sevastianov was in all probability: 'Do whatever you must to make sure that our young man gets his match with Korchnoi'. Campomanes was now in a perfect negotiating position, and it would

have been most uncharacteristic of the maximalist Filipino if he did not squeeze everything he could out of the Russians.

Thus it was that Campomanes was able to read aloud to Congress the following penitent message from Sevastianov on behalf of the USSR Chess Federation:

> DEAR MR PRESIDENT,
>
> IT IS REGRETTED THAT LATELY, INSTEAD OF REACHING ACCEPTABLE SOLUTIONS CONCERNING THE SEMIFINAL MATCHES, ACUTE POLEMICS BETWEEN THE USSR CHESS FEDERATION AND FIDE TOOK PLACE WHICH DOES NOT AGREE WITH THEIR LONG-STANDING, FRUITFUL AND CONSTRUCTIVE COOPERATION. THE USSR CHESS FEDERATION UNDERSTAND THAT IN ACCORDANCE WITH THE EXISTING RULES AND REGULATIONS FIDE PRESIDENT IS ENTRUSTED WITH THE RIGHT TO TAKE DECISIONS ON THE VENUES OF CANDIDATES' MATCHES IN BETWEEN CONGRESSES, AND IN TRYING TO RESOLVE THE PRESENT MISUNDERSTANDING, WITHDRAWS ITS PROTEST CONCERNING THE SEMIFINAL MATCHES FROM THE AGENDA OF THE 1983 FIDE CONGRESS. THE USSR CHESS FEDERATION EXPRESSES THE HOPE THAT THE INTERESTS OF THE GRANDMASTERS AND THE EFFORTS OF THE FIDE LEADERSHIP IN THIS DIRECTION WILL FIND SUPPORT IN THE WHOLE CHESS WORLD AND WILL STRENGTHEN FIDE,
> V SEVASTIANOV CHAIRMAN OF THE USSR CHESS FEDERATION.

Korchnoi, through the Swiss delegate, Walter Baumgartner, had told Congress that he would consent to replay the match with Kasparov, if such a Soviet apology were forthcoming. In addition, he demanded confirmation that the Korchnoi boycott would be ended. This condition was largely met through a motion proposed by Ray Keene: 'General Assembly extols the sportsmanship of Grandmaster Korchnoi and Grandmaster Ribli in agreeing to reply their Semi-Final matches. In the spirit of reconciliation, all boycotts, but most especially that of Mr Korchnoi, should be ended forthwith'. This was approved, say the minutes, 'by acclamation' with no Soviet objection recorded.

It only remained for Campomanes to conclude: 'Since the USSR Chess Federation now understands that FIDE regulations empower the President to decide venues of Candidates' matches during the period between Congresses, and in the light of a consensus from

members of the Executive Council, and having secured agreement of all parties concerned in the Semi-Final matches, I am considering steps to organise afresh the matches within the shortest possible time. With this statement the controversy of the Semi-Final matches rests'.

Of course the controversy did not rest there. The sponsors of the abortive Pasadena contest, the Western Chess Group, had incurred losses of about $50,000. Quoted in *Players' Chess News*, the President of the US Chess Federation, Tim Redman, had said: 'We do not want to stand in the way of efforts to revive the matches. Our support, though, is conditional upon the agreement of Korchnoi, Ribli and Campomanes and the full reimbursement of costs incurred by the USCF and other sponsors of the forfeited match'.

Since the switching of the venues from Pasadena to London, we have not heard a squeak of protest from Mr Redman, so one can only assume that the USCF did indeed receive their 'full reimbursement'. But who paid? Certainly not Campomanes or FIDE, since both had been totally vindicated in the Manila Congress. Could the lettering on the cheque have been Cyrillic? Furthermore, FIDE itself, in sheer travel, communication and waste of man-hours must have absorbed heavy losses (perhaps as much as $100,000) fighting its four-month-long campaign against the USSR Chess Federation. There are many who believe that the USSR did more than apologise for that dispute.

They believe that a deal between Sevastianov and Campomanes was struck on the 8th floor of the Manila Regent Hotel, involving promises by the USSR to hand over sufficient quantities of valuable Western currency to pacify all concerned. As noted, the USCF and FIDE would have to be satisfied, and it is also believed that Campomanes negotiated a recompense on behalf of Korchnoi for having to play a match he had already been declared to have won. The most reliable estimate of this figure is $30,000. The irony of the USSR paying a large sum to a man they had effectively barred from big money tournaments for seven years is obvious but nonetheless delicious.

It is also believed that a substantial advance sum from an estimated $180,000 reparations was transferred at the time of the Manila Congress. This sum would have been at least enough to meet the requirements of the USCF. What, though, would be the means of generating any remaining shortfall to cover the needs of FIDE and Korchnoi? The answer is not difficult to find. Since 50% of all prizes won by Soviet grandmasters in Western tournaments is always

retained by their Federation, that would represent a ready source of future revenue. This is especially true in a year when three Soviet grandmasters – Karpov, Kasparov and Smyslov – are involved in a world championship cycle with record prize funds. Quite what will happen if both the non-Soviets are eliminated in London, and the concluding phases are played exclusively in Moscow with nothing but roubles at stake, is the headache of the Soviet Chess Federation.

In one sense the cause of the dispute lay with Gary Kasparov himself. For hitherto the Candidates' Semi-Final matches had not been on the short list of the chess world's sponsors. It had often been quite a struggle to find a federation prepared to come up with the prize fund required by FIDE. But with the arrival of the charismatic prodigy from Baku on the scene, federations were actually having to compete to hold a Semi-Final Candidates' match. And so Campomanes had a choice.

three
THE BRITISH CONNECTION

On the afternoon of Monday 17 October I found a message on my desk at the *Financial Times*: 'Ray Keene says he is back from Manila. Could you ring him. Urgent'. I recalled a lunch with Ray, at the time that Abu Dhabi had pulled the rug from under Campomanes' feet. The matches had seemed doomed and our prognostications for the future of world chess verged on the apocalyptic. But when we finally got together on 18 October it became clear that reports of the death of FIDE had been greatly exaggerated. The matches were safe, and Ray had told Campomanes before leaving Manila that he would try to organise a bid for both Semi-Finals. In keeping with his policy, Campomanes had insisted that any bidder must offer a venue and a prize fund for both matches. Also, to be realistic, the chances of any federation offering to stage the Ribli-Smyslov match in isolation were negligible.

Ray told me that Campomanes would declare which federation had won the right to hold the matches on Monday morning, 24 October. Could I get someone to come up with at least £60,000 before then? That figure represented the smallest prize fund that could reasonably be offered for the matches. But obviously any would-be sponsor would have to reckon with many other costs, aside from merely paying the four players. Normally it would be the job of the British Chess Federation to find such a benefactor. Keene had alerted them of this possibility a few weeks earlier, but according to IM Jon Tisdall in *Chess Express,* 'The BCF rummage through their usual connections and adopt a stance of optimistic resignation'.

By the time Ray got through to me, there seemed no time left. In a few days we had to find and persuade someone who had never before sponsored chess in this country to put up a record British prize fund for an event of unspecified duration, and one of unknown interest to the British public and media.

The same day that Ray left his message, I had a phone call from Christopher Ward, former Editor of the *Daily Express*, and now a director of Acorn Computer, the designer of the BBC microcomputer. We had met at a press conference a few weeks earlier when Acorn had announced its plans to go public in an offer which valued the five year old company at £135m. Christopher was asking me to come along to a reception at Claridges on Wednesday 19 October. It was being held for an American merchant bank, LF Rothschild Unterberg Towbin, but aside from Christopher Ward the managing director of Acorn, Mr Christopher Curry, would also be present. When I had met Acorn earlier, they had told me of their intention to develop a very strong chess-playing programme. I had replied that I was a keen chessplayer, and Christopher Curry had suggested – how seriously I was not sure – that I help them with the project. Now I had a proposition to put to Mr Curry.

I pointed out that we needed to know Acorn's answer by Saturday, since we had to formulate our bid in time for Campomanes to make his announcement in Lucerne on Monday 24 October. There was a particularly tense evening on Thursday, while Acorn were thinking hard, and other bids appeared to be coming in thick and fast. Ray, myself and our wives, Annette and Jane, together with American IM Jon Tisdall and *Chess Express* publisher Nathan Goldberg were leaving Château Keene for a meal at 'Memories of India' in Gloucester Road when, again in the words of Tisdall in *Chess Express*:

As the Keene/Lawson team is halfway out the door to discuss the ongoing negotiations, the phone rings. It's Campomanes. A figure (not exactly a bid) has come in from Spain for $200,000 . . .. More confounding news arrives in the form of Radames Kulenović, an aspiring Yugoslav journalist, who arrives in London and informs Ray that a group of Bosnians have raised $250,000, but haven't made a formal offer to FIDE. Ignoring the chaos, talks continue. Information trickles in that the Spanish bid has been organised by Rafael Tudela of Venezuala, the Deputy President of FIDE.

Despite the worry, Acorn agree to go ahead and the offer is made in a mood of fighting spirit, defying the other exorbitant bids to materialise. They don't. FIDE awards Britain the match and the hard work begins.

In fact Acorn did not finally give us the go-ahead to bid until Monday lunchtime, by which time Ray and I had very little hair left.

Fortunately Campomanes, aware that we were on the verge of making a bid worth around Sw. Fr. 200,000, had stretched the deadline to Tuesday 25 October. Also, he wanted to give the Yugoslavs and the Spanish a last chance to put their money on the table. It turned out that the competition to hold the matches came not from Spain or Yugoslavia, but from Campomanes' old friends, the Dutch.

The original Dutch bid in May had failed, Campomanes told me, by a paltry Sw. Fr. 5,000 (not much more than £1,500). At the Manila Congress, the Dutch delegate, Mr Jongsma, had repeatedly pressed Campomanes to give the matches to Holland there and then, since no other federation had thrown its hat into the ring. Campomanes had refused to be rushed. Of course, apart from his memories of the Dutch attacks on his Presidential campaign in 1982, Campomanes had another reason for giving us time to challenge the Dutch bid (which was to hold the matches in, yes, Rotterdam). If Korchnoi-Kasparov had finally taken place in Rotterdam, where the Soviets had alone insisted it be held, then the USSR Chess Federation would definitely have had the last (if expensive) laugh on Campomanes.

Here is the text of our final offer made on 26 October:

ATT: PRESIDENT CAMPOMANES. IN VIEW OF OUR CONVERSATIONS YESTERDAY BRITISH CHESS FEDERATION IS NOW PREPARED TO REVISE AND INCREASE OUR BID FOR BOTH CANDIDATES SEMI-FINALS ON THE FOLLOWING BASIS:

A) TOTAL 130,000 SWISS FRANCS PRIZE FUND TO BE DISTRIBUTED AS FIDE SEE FIT BETWEEN BOTH MATCHES.

B) CONTRIBUTION TO FIDE 20,000 SWISS FRANCS TO BE USED AT THE DISCRETION OF FIDE EITHER FOR ITS OWN PURPOSES OR TO INCREASE PRIZE FUND TO 150,000 SWISS FRANCS.

C) FURTHER CONTRIBUTION TO FIDE 50,000 SWISS FRANCS WHICH INCLUDES PERCENTAGE OF PRIZE FUND AS PER REGULATIONS.

D) FURTHER CONTRIBUTION TO FIDE SPECIFICALLY FOR CACDEC CONSISTING OF 40,000 SWISS FRANCS WORTH OF CHESS MATERIAL.

E) DONATION TO FIDE OF AN ACORN ELECTRON COMPUTER FOR EACH OF:

1) CACDEC 2) QUALIFICATION COMMISSION 3) CHIPS.

F) ALL TELEVISION REVENUE (IF ANY) TO BE SHARED ON THE BASIS 60% FOR FIDE AND 40% FOR ORGANISATION COMMITTEE.

G) FULFILMENT OF ALL FURTHER EXPENSES AND OBLIGATIONS AS PER FIDE REGULATIONS.

I LOOK FORWARD TO HEARING YOUR DECISION THIS AFTERNOON REGARDS RAYMOND KEENE.

Part D of the bid was a master-stroke. CACDEC is the fund for the developing chess countries, which is a cause engraved on Campomanes' heart. It had been the Pasadena organisers' 'contribution' to this cause which had swung the bidding their way for the abortive first Kasparov-Korchnoi match. Our problem was that, Acorn having come up with the Sw. Fr. 150,000 we had asked for, it was unreasonable to expect them then to engage in a Dutch auction conducted by Campomanes. Then Keene had the idea of asking Batsford's, *Chess*, Bob Wade and the *British Chess Magazine* to make available Sw. Fr. 40,000 worth of chess books for CACDEC. That figure of Sw. Fr. 40,000 was the exact amount by which we beat off the Dutch bid of Sw. Fr. 150,000.

The next day, 27 October, we received a telex from Lucerne. Campomanes had made up his mind:

THE WORLD CHESS CHAMPIONSHIP SEMIFINAL MATCHES BETWEEN GARY KASPAROV OF THE SOVIET UNION AND VIKTOR KORCHNOI OF SWITZERLAND AND BETWEEN ZOLTAN RIBLI OF HUNGARY AND VASILY SMYSLOV OF THE SOVIET UNION WILL BE ORGANISED BY THE BRITISH CHESS FEDERATION IN LONDON NEXT MONTH. THE OPENING CEREMONY WILL BE ON NOVEMBER 18 AND THE FIRST GAMES WILL START NOVEMBER 19 1983.

THE EVENT WILL BE SPONSORED BY ACORN COMPUTERS WHICH HAS PUT UP A PRIZE FUND OF SFR. 100,000 FOR THE KASPAROV-KORCHNOI MATCH AND SFR. 50,000 FOR THE RIBLI-SMYSLOV MATCH IN ADDITION TO THE COST OF STAGING THE GAMES.

IN THE FIDE CONGRESS HELD IN MANILA EARLY THIS MONTH THE USSR CHESS FEDERATION ACKNOWLEDGED FINALLY THAT FIDE PRESIDENT WAS EMPOWERED BY THE REGULATIONS GOVERNING THE MATCHES TO CHOOSE THE VENUES. THUS ENDS THE FIVE MONTH CONTROVERSY BETWEEN FIDE AND THE

USSR CHESS FEDERATION WHICH HAD OBJECTED TO THE VENUES CHOSEN BY FIDE PRESIDENT IN MAY, NAMELY PASADENA, USA, AND ABU DHABI, UAE, RESPECTIVELY, AND WHICH LED TO THE SOVIET PLAYERS DEFAULTING THEIR MATCHES.

A MEETING IN LUCERNE YESTERDAY, 26 OCTOBER, BETWEEN THE INTERESTED PARTIES CONCLUDED THE NEGOTIATIONS MADE BY THE FIDE PRESIDENT FOR THE MATCHES TO BE ORGANISED AFRESH. PRESENT AT THE MEETING PRESIDED OVER BY FIDE PRESIDENT MR CAMPOMANES WERE REPRESENTATIVES OF THE USSR CHESS FEDEARTON, THE HUNGARIAN CHESS FEDERATION AND THE SWISS CHESS FEDERATION AS WELL AS GRANDMASTER VIKTOR KORCHNOI AND GRANDMASTER ZOLTAN RIBLI.

THE MATCHES WILL BE DECIDED OVER 12 GAMES WITH THE WINNERS PLAYING EACH OTHER IN THE CANDIDATES FINALS TO DECIDE WHO WILL PLAY WORLD CHESS CHAMPION ANATOLI KARPOV FOR THE WORLD TITLE NEXT YEAR.

On 29 October Campomanes made his official announcement 'for information of press':

I WARMLY CONGRATULATE THE BRITISH CHESS FEDERATION FOR STAGING THE WORLD CHESS CHAMPIONSHIP CANDIDATES' SEMI FINAL MATCHES NEXT MONTH. THERE HAS NOT BEEN AN IMPORTANT FIDE EVENT IN BRITAIN IN THE PAST THIRTY YEARS AND FOR THE COUNTRY THAT WAS ONE OF THE FOUNDING MEMBERS OF FIDE IN 1924, THAT IS, PERHAPS, A STRANGE OVERSIGHT, BUT I AM CONFIDENT THAT HENCEFORTH WE MAY LOOK FORWARD TO GREATE CHESS HAPPENINGS IN BRITAIN.

The same day we received a less official telex from the General Secretary of FIDE:

MAY I ADD PERSONAL EXPRESSION OF GRATIFICATION BCF IS NOW AT THE CREASE . . . LONG OVERDUE, PLS MAKE A CENTURY OR TWO. REGARDS LIM KOK ANN GENERAL SECRETARY.

four
FIGHTING CHESS
Raymond Keene

This is the title of Gary Kasparov's own volume of his selected masterpieces, yet this description applies with equal validity to the style of Viktor Korchnoi. English grandmaster Jon Speelman has described to me vividly the unpleasant sensation of facing Kasparov across the chessboard – rather like being hit with a succession of energy waves – and a man who can generate this kind of power will not give in lightly. He will fight to the bitter end to overwhelm any opponent he has to meet. The same applies to Korchnoi. Although his mental muscles are flexed to the maximum every game, there is less of a physical presence than with Kasparov, except for those phases of the struggle when Korchnoi comes into clock-trouble, and he has to smash out his moves in microseconds to avoid time forfeit. Nevertheless Korchnoi's whole career has been one long fight, off the chessboard against Soviet authorities and on the board, for over 20 years, to seize the chess crown he believes can be his.

Without doubt, a charisma attaches to both of these grandmasters which has somehow eluded the reigning World Champion, Anatoly Karpov. A man who, despite his virtually unprecedented record as champion, is unfairly, but irrevocably perceived as a colourless player. Given the tragic fact of Bobby Fischer's terminal hibernation and the mute public reaction to the achievements of Karpov, the two London contestants, Korchnoi and Kasparov, are now widely held to be the most attractive and popular players on the globe. The situation is very similar to that of the mid 1970's, when everyone had been hugely impressed by the 1972 Fischer-Spassky clash. When quizzed as to who was the strongest player in the world, the man on the Clapham Omnibus would tend to reply, Boris Spassky, even though Karpov sat secure on his throne in Moscow.

This syndrome even spread to the upper echelons of British chess officialdom. When the 1978 World Championship (between Karpov

and Korchnoi) got under way in the Philippines an aspiring youngster (now Candidate GM Jim Plaskett) asked the President of the British Chess Federation who should win. This worthy (whose name I will here suppress) pondered a while and delivered his verdict: Spassky!

Perhaps this image problem lies in the way in which Korchnoi, Kasparov and Karpov despatch their opponents. In the public mind, Korchnoi comes across as an anarchist, who tries to blow his opponents up in broad daylight, Kasparov as a young chess Napoleon with very big guns at his command, while Karpov projects as a gendarme who prefers to keep his opponents heavily manacled under lock and key.

When Korchnoi, Kasparov and, of course, Mikhail Tal, produce a winning sacrifice, it is always heralded as a new act of coruscating genius, but when Karpov does exactly the same thing, it is usually put down as a product of his extensive opening preparation, or dismissed as an unsound speculation, even if it has worked!

Over the next few pages I want to show the reader examples of the respective styles of Korchnoi and Kasparov, by analysing their previous games together, and demonstrating the difficult routes they took to reach the London semi-final.

five
PREVIOUS ENCOUNTERS

The atmosphere was electric at Lucerne last year when Kasparov and Korchnoi contested their Olympiad game. I cannot ever remember witnessing such a full-blooded game in the flesh.

David Anderton,
International Director of the
British Chess Federation

This quotation from David Anderton, who is also Captain of the English Team and a past President of the BCF (not the one who thought Spassky was playing in 1978!), reveals the high level of excitement with which all chess lovers were looking forward to the match between the two K's. In fact, they had only met once before London in a serious tournament game, and their other two clashes occurred in the Blitz tournament at Herceg Novi in September 1983, the kind of event where players had a mere 5 minutes to complete all of their moves. Along with the Lucerne game, I will cite one of the Blitz games here, and give what is extant of the other in my notes to game 2 of the match.

	Lucerne Olympiad 1982	*Herceg Novi* 1983		*total*
		Rd 1	Rd 2	
Korchnoi	0	0	0	**0**
Kasparov	1	1	1	**3**

Is it just possible that Kasparov's overwhelming score gave him an inflated sense of self-confidence before the London match began?

Korchnoi-Kasparov
Lucerne Olympiad 1982
Modern Benoni Defence

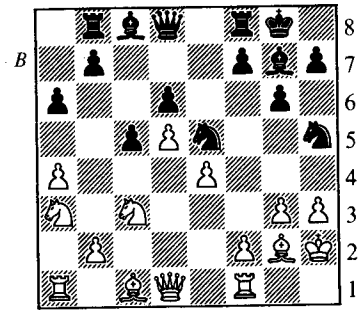
1	**d4**	**♘f6**
2	**c4**	**g6**
3	**g3**	**♗g7**
4	**♗g2**	**c5**
5	**d5**	**d6**
6	**♘c3**	**0-0**
7	**♘f3**	**e6**

Transposing into the Benoni – ideally suited to Kasparov's uncompromising style.

8	**0-0**	**ed**
9	**cd**	**a6**

10	**a4**	**♖e8**
11	**♘d2**	**♘bd7**
12	**h3**	**♖b8**
13	**♘c4**	**♘e5**
14	**♘a3**	**♘h5**
15	**e4**	**♖f8**
16	**♔h2**	

Safer was 16 ♕e2, discouraging ... b5.



16 ... f5!?

Probably better is 16 ... ♗d7! to meet 17 f4 with ... b5!

17 f4

Not 17 ef ♗xf5 18 g4? ♗xg4! 19 hg ♕h4+ winning. But now if Black's knight retreats 18 ef really is strong. However . . .

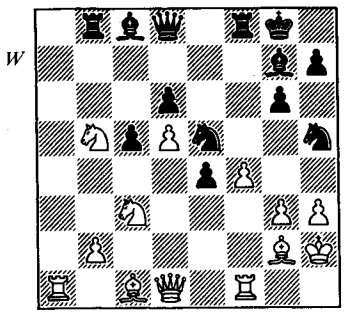
17 ... b5!!

A magnificent conception, whether or not it is completely sound. Black leaves his knight to its fate for seven moves and relies on diversionary tactics.

18	**ab**	**ab**
19	**♘axb5**	

If 19 fe ♗xe5! threatening both 20 ... b4 and 20 ... ♘xg3, is very strong.

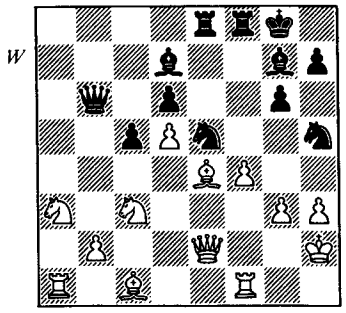
19 ... fe



20 ♗xe4

Now if 20 fe ♗xe5 21 ♗f4 ♘xf4 22 gf ♗xf4+ 23 ♔h1 ♕h4 gives Black a murderous attack but 22 ♖xf4 may be an improvement. But Kasparov was unaware that all this had happened before! Alburt-H.Olafsson, Reykjavik 1982, had gone 20 ♘a7 e3!? And what of Korchnoi? He was present at Reykjavik 1982, and assisted at the post-mortem of Alburt-Olafsson!

20	**...**	**♗d7**
21	**♕e2**	**♕b6**
22	**♘a3**	**♖be8**



At this moment I entered the playing hall and decided to try and watch the Korchnoi-Kasparov

game. Of course, it was impossible to see anything - hundreds of spectators had crowded around the game and people were even standing on chairs to get a better view. I then glanced up at the manual demonstration board perched above the players' heads and saw the position in the diagram. My immediate reaction was, poor Gary, he's a pawn down, and when he retreats his attacked knight on e5, then White can play the strong ♘c4. Then I realised it was Korchnoi's move!! This is, in fact, the most critical moment. Over to Kasparov himself for his explanation:

'Now what is to done if Korchnoi takes the knight? After 23 fe one can look into 23 ... ♗xe5 (23 ... ♖xf1 is also possible) 24 ♗f4 ♘xf4 25 gf ♗xf4! 26 ♔g2 ♕d8 when White has an extra piece but some poorly placed, e.g. the a3-knight, while Black has many advantages on the king's wing; if 24 ♘c4 ♗xg3+ 25 ♔g1 ♕d8 I think this line is playable for Black. At this moment my opponent made a serious error. He could have played 23 ♕g2 to consolidate by taking the e5 knight and following with ♘e2. According to some critics this would have refuted 16 ... f5. Surely after 23 ... ♘f7 24 ♘c4 ♕b8 the battle is still ahead? White's extra pawn has to be balanced by his weaknesses on central squares and poorly co-ordinated pieces. After 23 ♗e3 ♘f7 24 ♘c4 ♕d8 White is congested'.

23	**♗d2?**	**♕xb2**
24	**fe**	

At last White accepts the bait - and his position rapidly disintegrates. The immediate 24 ♖fb1 failed to 24 ... ♘f3+ but 24 ♔g2, threatening 25 ♖fb1 is a severe test of Black's play. One sample variation runs: 24 ♔g2 ♘f7 25 ♖fb1 ♗xc3 26 ♖xb2 ♗xb2 27 ♖a2 ♗d4 28 ♕d3 ♘g5 29 ♗xg6 and White is on top. However, the precarious 24 ... ♕b4 seems to keep Black in the game.

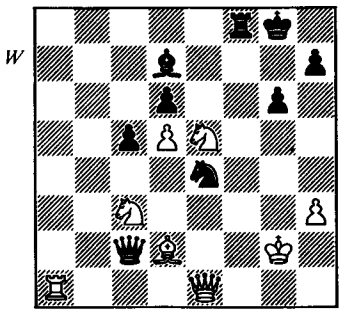
24	**...**	**♗xe5**
25	**♘c4**	**♘xg3**
26	**♖xf8+**	**♖xf8**
27	**♕e1**	

An admission of defeat, but there was no adequate alternative.

27	**...**	**♘xe4+**
28	**♔g2**	**♕c2**
29	**♘xe5**	

Or 29 ♖c1 ♕d3 threatening 30 ... ♕xh3+.

Now 29 ... ♘xd2 wins.



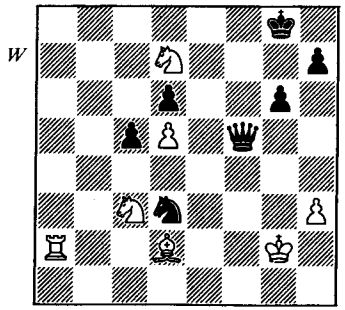
29 ... ♖f2+?

Kasparov: 'This spoils the game and makes the win uncertain. I had prepared for 30 ♔g1, but . . . '

30 ♕xf2!

'Gives me a choice between 30 ... ♘xf2 and 30 ... ♗xh3+. If the latter then 31 ♔g1! ♘xf2 32 ♖a2! poses Black a problem as to where to put the queen – if 32 ... ♕f5 33 ♖a8+ leads to a perpetual check as the black queen obstructs his rook, or 32 ... ♕b3 33 ♖a8+ ♔g7 34 ♖a7+ ♔f8 35 ♗h6+ ♔e8 36 ♖a8+ ♔e7 37 ♗g5 mate and here if Black tries to run his king through the centre by 34 ... ♔f6 White has 35 ♘f3 (threatening mate in four by 36 ♗g5+ ♔f5 37 ♖f7+ etc) and after 35 ... ♘d3 another king chase by 36 ♘e4+ ♔h3 37 ♘xd6+ ♔g4 38 ♘h2+ ♔g3 39 ♘e4+ ♔h3 40 ♖xh7 mate. These variations show the active co-operation of White's pieces after 30 ... ♗xh3+. I intuitively chose . . . '

30	**...**	**♘xf2**
31	**♖a2!**	**♕f5!**
32	**♘xd7**	**♘d3**



'After the game I devoted an enormous amount of time to analysing this position. In severe time trouble, Korchnoi played poorly . . . '

33 ♗h6?

White should play 33 ♖a8+ ♔f7 34 ♖a7! – as Korchnoi pointed out immediately after the game.

33	**...**	**♕xd7**
34	**♖a8+**	**♔f7**
35	**♖h8?**	**♔f6**
36	**♔f3??**	**♕xh3+**

White lost on time.

Kasparov-Korchnoi
World Blitz
Herceg Novi, September 1983
Nimzo-Indian Defence

1	**d4**	**♘f6**
2	**c4**	**e6**
3	**♘c3**	

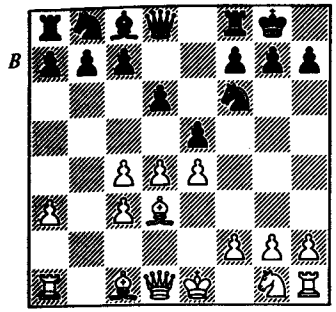
Normally Kasparov plays 3 ♘f3 b6 4 ♘c3 ♗b7 5 a3, a variation which is likely to be a bone of contention in their London contest.

3	**...**	**♗b4**
4	**e3**	**0-0**
5	**a3**	

Kasparov also experimented with the Sämisch variation in games against Belyavsky in the USSR Spartakiade, Ivanović at Nikšić and Timman at Herceg Novi.

5	**...**	**♗xc3+**
6	**bc**	**d6**

7	**♗d3**	**e5**
8	**e4**	



8	**...**	**c5**

Korchnoi has a shot here with 8 ... ed 9 cd ♘xe4!? 10 ♗xe4 ♖e8 though after 11 ♕e2 f5 12 ♗d5+ ♔h8 13 ♗e3 f4 things are not so clear.

9	**♘e2**	**♘c6**
10	**0-0**	

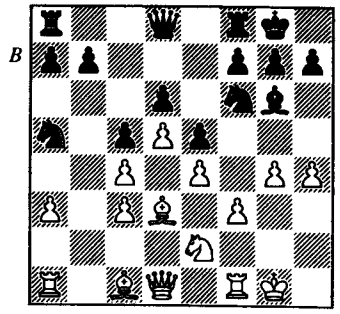
Barden described this as 'an obscure gambit', which would be quite in Kasparov's style. 10 d5 is the main line.

10	**...**	**♗g4?**

Eccentric and incorrect. He should accept the gift with 10 ... cd.

11	**f3**	**♗h5**
12	**d5**	**♘a5**
13	**g4**	**♗g6**
14	**h4**	

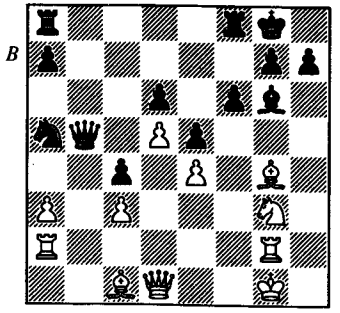
Black is in peril of being swamped, e.g. 14 ... h5 15 g5 ♘h7 16 f4 f5 17 ef ♘xf5 18 ♗xf5 ♖xf5 19 ♕d3 or 19 ♘g3. His remedy is a rather desperate sacrifice.



14	**...**	**♘xg4**
15	**fg**	**♕xh4**
16	**♖f2**	**♕xg4+**
17	**♖g2**	**♕d7**
18	**♘g3**	**f6**
19	**♖1a2**	

Preparing an 'Arabic' development along the second rank, to which I have already drawn attention in *Learn from the Grandmasters* and *How to Play the Nimzo-Indian.*

19	**...**	**b5**
20	**cb**	**c4**
21	**♗e2**	**♕xb5**
22	**♗g4**	



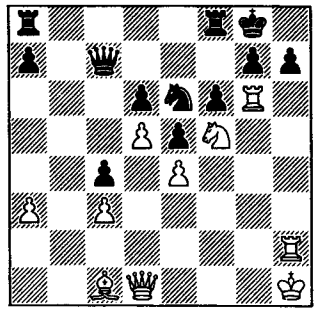
Preparing to hit the sensitive e6 square. Black's 3 pawns are no

equivalent for White's extra piece, since White has the initiative. Furthermore, Black cannot safely advance his passed pawns as they form the protective carapace around his king.

22	...	**♘b7**
23	**♖ab2**	**♕c5+**
24	**♔h1**	**♕c7**
25	**♗e6+**	**♔h8**
26	**♘f5**	**♘c5**
27	**♖xg6!**	**♘xe6**

Of course, not 27 ... hg 28 ♖h2 mate.

28	**♖h2**	**♔g8**
	diagram	
29	**♖xh7!**	



The final fireworks. Black must accept.

29	...	**♔xh7**
30	**♕h5+**	**♔g8**
31	**de**	**♖fe8**
32	**♗h6**	

1-0

six
ALL ROADS LEAD TO LONDON

Viktor Korchnoi has been continuously involved in the Candidates' stage of the World Championship cycle since 1968, and from 1974 he has been Karpov's sole antagonist in the three matches which have decided the destination of the world title itself. These were played at Moscow 1974, Baguio 1978 and Merano 1981. True, the first of them was, on paper, merely the Final of the Candidates' series. But there was never much hope that Fischer would defend the crown he wrested from Boris Spassky in 1972, so the general expectation was that the winner of Moscow 1974 could hardly avoid elevation to the throne.

Korchnoi's record of achievement and experience is vast and formidable. Indeed, after 31 games at Baguio 1978, where I was assisting him as his second, Korchnoi had scored 15½ points, exactly the same as Karpov, and was within one win of the supreme title. However, his most recent clash with Anatoly Karpov at Merano, in the Autumn of 1981, seemed to presage a sudden waning of his powers.

Here is the full record of Korchnoi's clashes with the Soviet incumbent:

MOSCOW 1974

Karpov	½	1	½	½	½	1	½	½	½	½	½	½	½	½	½	1	½	0	½	0	½	½	½		**12½**
Korchnoi	½	0	½	½	½	0	½	½	½	½	½	½	½	½	½	0	½	1	½	1	½	½	½		**11½**

BAGUIO 1978

Karpov	½	½	½	½	½	½	½	1	½	½	0	½	1	1	½	½	1	½	½	½	0	½	½	½	½	1	0	0	½	0	1	**16½**
Korchnoi	½	½	½	½	½	½	½	0	½	½	1	½	0	0	½	½	0	½	½	½	1	½	½	½	½	0	1	1	½	1	0	**15½**

MERANO 1981

Karpov	1	1	½	1	½	0	½	½	1	½	½	½	0	1	½	½	½	1	**11**
Korchnoi	0	0	½	0	½	1	½	½	0	½	½	½	1	0	½	½	½	0	**7**

Korchnoi-Karpov
13th Game, Merano 1981
Queen's Gambit Declined

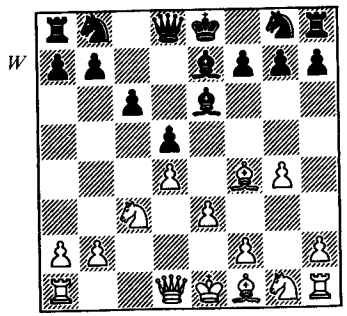
1	**c4**	**e6**
2	**♘c3**	**d5**
3	**d4**	**♗e7**
4	**cd**	**ed**
5	**♗f4**	**c6**

Karpov has sad memories of this line. Timman-Karpov, Bugojno 1978, went 5 ... ♘f6 6 e3 0-0 7 ♕c2 c6 8 ♗d3 ♖e8 9 ♘f3 ♘bd7 10 0-0-0 with the makings of a a strong white attack, which eventually brought him victory.

6	**e3**	**♗f5**
7	**g4!?**	

Korchnoi hits out with a super-sharp line, invented in the early 1960's by Botvinnik. Since Korchnoi has used it himself in the past it can have come as no surprise to the Russians.

7 ... ♗e6



7 ... ♗g6 looks consistent (controlling the b1-h7 diagonal) but is dangerous for tactical reasons, viz. 8 h4! (threatening g5, incarcerating Black's knight) 8 ... ♗xh4 9 ♕b3 b6 10 ♖xh4 ♕xh4 11 ♘xd5 and Black collapses.

8 h3

White has a vigorous alternative in Botvinnik's 8 h4!? e.g. 8 ... ♗xh4 9 ♕b3 b6 (9 ... ♗c8 10 e4) 10 ♘f3 ♗e7 11 ♗xb8 ♖xb8 12 ♘e5 ♖c8 (12 ... ♗d7 13 e4) 13 ♕a4 b5 14 ♕xa7. Vast complications arose in Vaiser-Geller, Sochi 1982, after 9 ... g5!? 10 ♗e5 f6 11 ♗h2 ♗xg4 12 ♕xb7 ♕e7 13 ♕xa8 ♕xe3+ with an eventual draw, but Geller has been reluctant to repeat this adventure in later games. Finally, an idea worth considering is Tony Miles' 8 ♗d3 ♘d7 9 ♕f3 h5 10 h3, followed by 0-0-0.

8	**...**	**♘f6**
9	**♘f3**	**0-0**
10	**♗d3**	**c5**

It is normal to strike back in the centre like this when White has organised a wing thrust, such as g4.

11 ♔f1

Artificial castling is more efficacious than 11 0-0, since White may need his king's rook on h1 for attacking purposes. It also helps to keep the h3 pawn continuously protected.

11	**...**	**♘c6**
12	**♔g2**	**♖c8**

Alternatively, 12 ... cd 13 ♘xd4 ♗d6 14 ♗xd6 ♕xd6 15 ♘3e2 ♖fe8 16 ♖c1, Geller-Spassky, Moscow 1967, or 13 ... ♘xd4 14 ed ♘d7 15 ♕c2, Botvinnik-Petrosian, match (14), Moscow 1963.

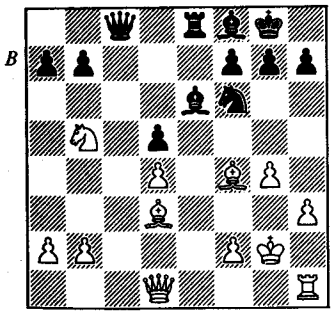
13 ♖c1

Bronstein's 13 dc ♗xc5 14 ♘e2 ♘e4 15 ♖c1 ♗e7 16 ♘fd4 ♘xd4 17 ♘xd4 ♕b6 also looks good for White.

13	**...**	**♖e8**
14	**dc**	**♗xc5**
15	**♘b5**	**♗f8**
16	**♘fd4!**	

A subtle move. Karpov had only been expecting 16 ♘bd4 and now, uncharacteristically, he sank into thought for 35 minutes.

16	**...**	**♘xd4**
17	**♖xc8**	**♕xc8**
18	**ed!**	



A profoundly perceptive recapture. Almost anyone else would have played 18 ♘xd4 to maintain a piece blockade over Black's IQP. Now White's knight on b5 threatens both to capture on a7 and to invade on c7.

18	**...**	**♕d7**
19	**♘c7**	

Here 19 ♘xa7 ♖a8 is pointless.

19 ... ♖c8

20 ♘xe6 fe

Black would prefer to play 20 ... ♕xe6 but it fails to 21 ♗f5. The text, however, leaves Black with a sickly pawn at e6 on an open file.

21	**♖e1**	**a6**
22	**g5**	

The sharpest way to proceed. The quiet 22 ♕e2 is also strong and gives enduring pressure.

22	**...**	**♘e4**
23	**♕g4**	

Of course, not 23 ♗xe4 de 24 ♖xe4 ♕d5, when Black has freed himself considerably at the cost of a mere pawn.

23	**...**	**♗b4**
24	**♖e2**	**♖f8**
25	**f3**	**♕f7**

Karpov launches an ingenious counterattack.

26 ♗e5

Not 26 fe ♕xf4.

26	**...**	**♘d2**
27	**a3**	**♘xf3**
28	**g6**	

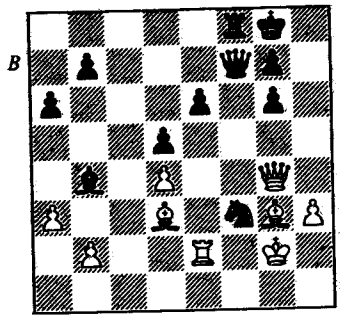
The only move of Korchnoi's in this game which can be criticised. Stronger is Tal's recommendation: 28 ♗g3 ♘h4+ 29 ♔h2 ♘f3+ 30 ♔h1 ♘h4 31 ♗xh7+ ♔xh7 32 ♕xh4+ and ♖f2.

28 ... hg

Hoping for 29 ab? ♘e1+ 30 ♖xe1 ♕f2+.

29 ♗g3!

Now Karpov misses his footing in the tangled forest of variations. The only correct path is the resource 29 ... ♘h4+!!, e.g. 30 ♕xh4



♕f3+ or 30 ♗xh4 ♕f1+ 31 ♔h2 ♗d6+ 32 ♗g3 ♖f2+ (32 ♖e5 ♗xe5+ 33 de ♕xd3). So, after 29 ... ♘h4+!! we have the following main lines: 30 ♔h2 ♘f3+ 31 ♔h1 ♘h4!!

a) **32 ♖f2** ♘f5 33 ♗xf5 gf attacking White's queen, or 33 ab ♘xg3+ 34 ♕xg3 ♕xf2.

b) **32 ♖c2** ♗e7 or alternatively 32 ... ♕f3+ 33 ♕xf3 ♖xf3 34 ♗xh4 ♗d6 threatening ... ♖xd3 and ... ♖xh3+.

c) **32 ♗xh4** ♕f1+ 33 ♔h2 ♗d6+ – see above.

d) **32 ♕xh4** ♕f3+ 33 ♖g2 ♕xd3 34 ab ♖f1+ 35 ♔g2 ♕d1 with a draw in view, or 35 ♖g1 ♕f3+ 36 ♔h2 ♕e2+ 37 ♖g2 ♕d1 and again White must take perpetual on d8 and h4.

29	...	**♗e7?**

A disastrous move, immediately losing material.

30	**♖f2!**	♘e1+
31	**♔h1**	♕xf2
32	**♗xf2**	♘xd3
33	**♕xe6+**	♖f7
34	**♗g3**	♘xb2
35	**♕xd5**	**♗f6**
36	**♗d6**	**g5**
37	**♕b3**	**♗xd4**
38	**♕e6**	**g6**
39	**♕e8+**	♔g7
40	**♗e5+**	**♗xe5**
41	**♕xe5+**	♔h7

Adjourned and resigned without resumption. In my book of Merano, I described this game as a jewel of attack.

seven
THE 1982-84 WORLD CHAMPIONSHIP CYCLE

The current world championship cycle is the last of the venerable series launched by FIDE in 1948. In those days, international travel and communication were not so well developed, while tools of measurement, such as the Elo rating list, did not exist to give realistic guidelines to the actual strength of the leading players. Accordingly, a 3 year period was set, in which the world champion had to defend his title and if he did not, (see Fischer in 1975) FIDE would strip him of the honour. The cycle was based on democratic, geographical criteria, consisting of worldwide Zonal, Interzonal and Candidates' qualifying stages, leading ultimately to the World Championship match itself. At the Manila FIDE Congress of October 1983, this excessively slow build-up was cut down to two years for all future championships, so what we are witnessing here are the final stages of the ultimate three-year FIDE cycle.

Korchnoi entered directly into the Candidates' tournament by virtue of his participation in the 1981 World Championship match, while Kasparov bypassed the Zonal stage because of his outstanding rating, speeding straight on to the Interzonal.

Post Merano, Korchnoi seemed to be caught up in an ineluctable decline, the nadir of which was his wretched performance at the 1982 Lloyds Bank Masters, held at the Barbican Centre in London. Here Korchnoi succumbed to the Indian youth Barua, and was very nearly scalped by the Swedish teenage girl, Pia Cramling:

Barua-Korchnoi
Lloyds Bank Masters 1982
Giuoco Piano

1	**e4**	**e5**
2	**♘f3**	**♘c6**
3	**♗c4**	**♗c5**
4	**0-0**	

Generally considered premature, since Black can now castle queenside and attack the white king. 4 c3 ♘f6 5 d3 is the fashionable line.

4	...	**♘f6**
5	**d3**	**d6**

6	c3	♗b6
7	♗g5	

Further provocation, which enables Black to advance his kingside pawns with gain of time.

7	...	h6
8	♗h4	♕e7
9	♘bd2	g5
10	♗g3	♗g4

Not 10 ... ♘h5 11 ♘xe5!

11	h3	♗d7
12	♗b3	♘h5

Now if 13 ♘xe5 ♘xg3 14 ♘xc6 bc and White cannot recapture on g3. However, the quiet 12 ... a6 deserves consideration, to conserve the valuble black king's bishop.

13	♘c4	♘f4

Or 13 ... ♘xg3 14 ♘xb6!

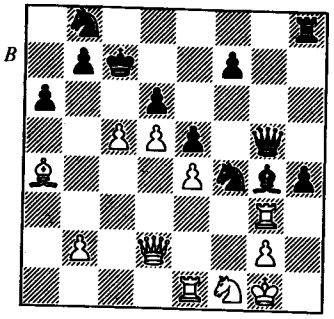
14	d4	0-0-0
15	a4	a6
16	d5	♘b8
17	♘xb6+	cb
18	♘d2	♖dg8
19	♘c4	♔c7
20	f3	

White has now created distinct counterchances by breaking up the defensive pawn wall in front of Black's king.

20	...	h5
21	♕d2	b5
22	♘e3	g4
23	h4	gf
24	♖xf3	♖xg3

A reasonable exchange sacrifice since the bishop is a good defender.

25	♖xg3	♕xh4
26	♘f1	ba
27	♗xa4	♗g4
28	♖e1	♕g5
29	c4	h4
30	c5!	

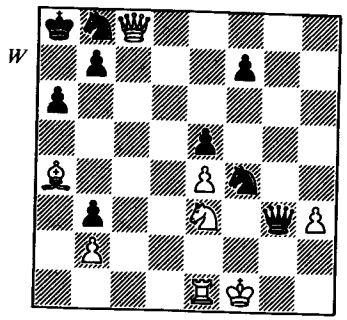


A fine resource, for if 30 ... hg 31 ♕a5+ ♔c8 32 cd makes White's attack the more dangerous.

30	...	dc
31	d6+	♔b6
32	♖b3+	♔a7
33	♕a5	♗c8
34	♘e3	c4

If 34 ... ♘h3+ 35 ♔f1 ♕f4+ 36 ♔e2 ♕f2+ 37 ♔d1!

35	d7	cb
36	♕c5+	♔a8
37	dc♕	♖xc8
38	♕xc8	♕g3
39	♔f1	h3
40	gh	♘d3?



In spite of his loss of material, Black still possesses a formidable attack. He could, of course, deliver perpetual check, while 40 ... ♕f3+ 41 ♔g1 ♘d3 is very promising. In desperate mutual time trouble, however, Korchnoi starts to go wrong. In fact the time control was at move 45, but the players now raced through to move 54, without pausing to write down their moves.

41	♔e2	♘xe1
42	♕g4	♕xg4+
43	♘xg4	

Black's attack has vanished, and in the endgame has has to watch out for White's passed h-pawn.

43	...	♘c2?

Heading in the wrong direction. 43 ... ♘g2 is more sensible.

44	♔d3	♘a1?

The worst possible square for halting the h-pawn, and the transparent threat of b5 is easily parried.

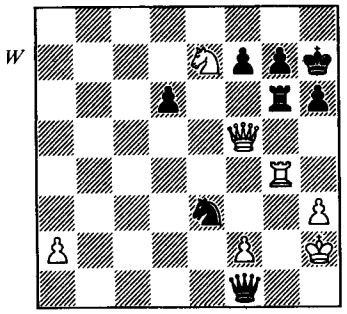
45	♗e8	♘c6
46	♗xc6	bc
47	h4	

It is a miracle that Korchnoi even comes close to stopping this pawn.

47	...	♘c2
48	h5	♘d4
49	h6	♘e6
50	h7	♘f4+
51	♔e3	♘g6
52	♘xe5!	♘h8
53	♘xf7!	♘xf7
54	e5	

1-0

The knight cannot hold up both pawns.



Pia Cramling-Korchnoi
Lloyds Bank Masters, 1982

White to play had Korchnoi on the ropes, not to say halfway out of the ring; however, in fearful time-pressure the young Swedish girl now played **39 fe??** allowing a draw by perpetual check after **39 ... ♕e2+ 40 ♔h1 ♕e1+ 41 ♔h2 ♕e2+** etc . . .

When the smoke had cleared, analytical vultures swiftly descended to prove that 39 ♕xf7! ♘xg4+ 40 hg leaves Viktor facing unavoidable checkmate.

Korchnoi's disaster at Lloyds Bank virtually coincided with Kasparov's greatest triumph to date – his victory, with two rounds to spare, at the strongest of the three 1982 Interzonals. The three games which follow show the kind of disdain with which he was able to treat GM opposition.

MOSCOW INTERZONAL 1982

		K	*B*	*T*	*A*	*G*	*G*	*M*	*C*	*S*	*V*	*G*	*V*	*R*	*Q*	*total*	
G.Kasparov	2675	■	½	½	½	½	½	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	½	**10**	1
A.Belyavsky	2620	½	■	1	½	1	1	0	1	0	1	1	0	½	1	**8½**	2
M.Tal	2610	½	0	■	½	½	½	1	½	½	1	½	1	1	½	**8**	3 =
U.Andersson	2610	½	½	½	■	½	0	1	½	½	½	1	1	½	1	**8**	3 =
Gu.Garcia	2500	½	0	½	½	■	½	1	0	1	1	½	1	0	1	**7½**	5 =
E.Geller	2565	½	0	½	1	½	■	½	1	0	1	½	½	1	½	**7½**	5 =
Y.Murey	2500	0	1	0	0	0	½	■	½	1	½	½	½	1	1	**6½**	7
L.Christiansen	2505	0	0	½	½	1	0	½	■	½	0	½	½	1	1	**6**	8 =
G.Sax	2560	0	1	½	½	0	1	0	½	■	½	½	0	½	1	**6**	8 =
D.Velimirović	2495	0	0	0	½	0	0	½	1	½	■	1	½	1	½	**5½**	10
F.Gheorghiu	2535	0	0	½	0	½	½	½	½	½	0	■	½	1	½	**5**	11 =
J.Van der Wiel	2520	0	1	0	0	0	½	½	½	1	½	½	■	0	½	**5**	11 =
R.Rodriguez	2415	0	½	0	½	1	0	0	0	½	0	0	1	■	1	**4½**	13
M.Quinteros	2520	½	0	½	0	0	½	0	0	0	½	½	½	0	■	**4½**	14

Kasparov-Sax
Moscow IZ Round 1
Grünfeld Defence

1	**d4**	**♘f6**
2	**c4**	**g6**
3	**♘c3**	**d5**
4	**cd**	**♘xd5**
5	**e4**	**♘xc3**
6	**bc**	**♗g7**
7	**♗c4**	

Switching from his normal 7 ♘f3, this old main line was probably prepared by Kasparov and his second Nikitin, especially for the Interzonal.

7	**...**	**0-0**
8	**♗e3**	**b6**

A risky idea, but one frequently employed by Sax and his compatriot Adorjan. The most solid continuation is 8 ... c5 9 ♘e2 cd 10 cd ♘c6 11 0-0 ♗g4 12 f3 ♘a5 13 ♗d3 ♗e6, when Kasparov would probably have sacrificed the exchange with 14 d5 ♗xa1 15 ♕xa1 f6 16 ♖b1.

9 h4

Kasparov wastes no time in setting about Black's king. If now 9 ... ♘c6 10 h5 ♘a5 11 hg ♘xc4 12 ♕h5 gives White a terrible attack.

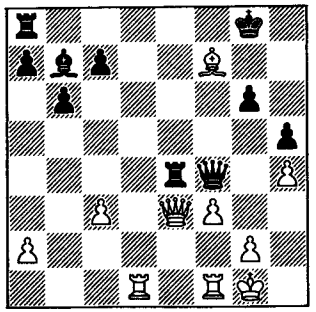
9	**...**	**♗b7**
10	**♕f3**	**♕d7**
11	**♘e2**	**h5**
12	**♗g5**	**♘c6**
13	**♘f4**	**e6**
14	**♖d1**	**♘a5**
15	**♗d3**	**e5**

A new move. In an earlier game between two East German Grandmasters Black succumbed after 15 ... c5? 16 ♖h3 cd 17 ♘xh5! gh 18 ♗f6 when the threat of ♖g3 is deadly.

16	**de**	**♗xe5**
17	**0-0**	**♕g4**
18	**♕e3**	**♖fe8**
19	**♗e2**	**♗xf4**
20	**♗xf4**	**♘c4?!**

An ingenious defence, but it fails to a brilliant stream of tactics. Correct is 20 ... ♕xh4, though after 21 e5 ♕e7 22 ♕g3, White has enormous compensation for the pawn.

21	**♗xc4**	**♖xe4**
22	**f3**	**♕xf4**
23	**♗xf7+!**	



Both 23 ... ♕xf7 and 23 ... ♔xf7 now fail to 24 fe, so White will win a vital pawn.

23	**...**	**♔g7**
24	**♕d3!**	

Forcing the exchange of queens into an ending where Black stands miserably.

24	**...**	**♕e3+**
25	**♕xe3**	**♖xe3**
26	**♖d7**	**♔h6**
27	**♖xc7**	**♗a6**
28	**♖d1**	**♗d3**
29	**♖d2**	**♗f5**
30	**♔f2**	**♖e5**
31	**♖d5**	**♖xd5**
32	**♗xd5**	**♖d8**
33	**c4**	**b5**
34	**♔e3**	**a5**
35	**♔f4**	**♗b1**
36	**g4**	**hg**
37	**fg**	

1-0

There is no defence to g5+.

Kasparov-Murei
Moscow IZ Round 3
Queen's Indian Defence

1	**d4**	**♘f6**
2	**c4**	**e6**
3	**♘f3**	**b6**
4	**♘c3**	**♗b7**

I really believe 4 ... ♗b4 is more sensible, particularly against Kasparov, who has made a special study of the a3 systems, which he now employs.

5	**a3**	**d5**
6	**cd**	**♘xd5**
7	**♕c2**	

A probable improvement on

the normal 7 e3.

7 ... c5

More circumspect is 7 ... ♗e7 (see Portisch-Christiansen, Phillips and Drew, 1982).

8 e4 ♘xc3
9 bc ♘c6
10 ♗b2 ♖c8
11 ♖d1

Strange as it may seem, Kasparov is the first to have introduced this natural configuration of White's queen's bishop and queen's rook into this variation.

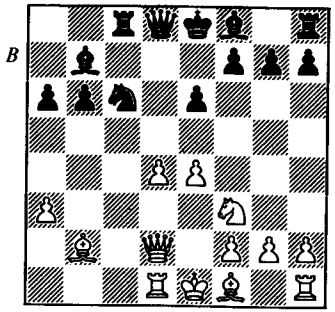
11 ... cd

Foolhardy, since it frees the diagonal for White's queen's bishop, and there is no way to profit from the discovery against White's queen.

12 cd a6

If 12 ... ♘xd4? 13 ♕a4+ wins, while 12 ... ♘b4? is pointless after 13 ♗b5+.

13 ♕d2!



Avoiding tricks and building up behind the d-pawn.

13 ... ♘a5
14 d5 ed
15 ed ♗d6

From this point on, in the post-mortem, it looked as if Black was lost. The obvious move 15 ... ♕e7+ fails to 16 ♗e2 ♘c4 17 d6! and the pawn cannot be captured by the queen because of ♗xc4 while if ♘xd6 White simply castles.

16 ♗xg7 ♕e7+
17 ♗e2 ♖g8
18 ♕h6 f5
19 ♗f6 ♕f8
20 ♕xh7 ♕f7
21 ♕xf5 ♖g6
22 ♕e4+ ♔f8
23 ♘g5 ♖xg5
24 ♗xg5 ♖e8
25 ♗h6+ ♔g8
26 ♕g4+

1-0

Kasparov-Gheorghiu
Moscow IZ Round 11
Queen's Indian Defence

1 d4 ♘f6
2 c4 e6
3 ♘f3 b6
4 a3 ♗b7
5 ♘c3 d5
6 cd ♘xd5
7 ♕c2 c5
8 e4 ♘xc3
9 bc ♗e7

Varying from the Murei game above.

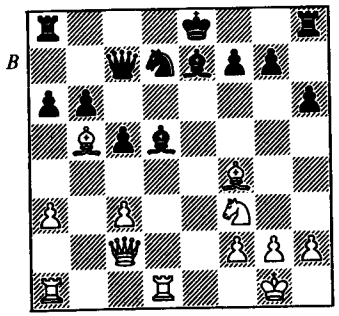
10 ♗b5+ ♗c6
11 ♗d3 ♘d7
12 0-0 h6

Or 12 ... 0-0 13 d5 ed 14 ed ♗xd5 15 ♗xh7+ removing an important component of the black king's defences. The text, however, looks like a dangerous loss of time, just the sort of thing Kasparov is excellent at exploiting.

13 ♖d1 ♕c7

Still afraid to castle, but now d5 comes with even greater force as a sacrifice.

14 d5 ed
15 ed ♗xd5
16 ♗b5 a6
17 ♗f4!!



A beautiful shot which disrupts Black's co-ordination. The point is to drive Black's king into the open.

17 ... ♕xf4
18 ♗xd7+ ♔xd7
19 ♖xd5+ ♔c7

After 19 ... ♔e8 20 ♖e1 comes with equal force, pinning the bishop.

20 ♖e1 ♗d6

If 20 ... ♗f6 21 ♖e4 traps Black's queen in mid-board.

21 ♖f5 ♕c4
22 ♖e4 ♕b5
23 ♖xf7+ ♔b8
24 ♖e6 ♖d8
25 c4 ♕c6
26 ♘e5 ♕c8

And just when we were all expecting the powerful centralisation 27 ♕e4, there came the even more deadly retreat

27 ♕b1!

1-0

There is no defence to ♕xb6+ since 27 ... b5 28 cb is patently hopeless.

MOSCOW, March 1983

2690	**Kasparov**	½	1	½	0	1	½	½	1	1	6
2570	**Belyavsky**	½	0	½	1	0	½	½	0	0	3

BAD KISSINGEN, March-April 1983

2600	**Korchnoi**	1	½	1	1	½	½	½	0	1	6
2620	**Portisch**	0	½	0	0	½	½	½	1	0	3

Belyavsky-Kasparov
4th Match Game, Moscow 1983
Nimzo-Indian Defence

1	d4	♘f6
2	c4	e6
3	♘c3	♗b4

The Nimzo-Indian is one of the most solid and highly respected defences to 1 d4, yet, paradoxically, Kasparov has normally avoided it, preferring the Benoni, King's Indian and latterly the Tarrasch. On those rare occasions when Kasparov has adopted the Nimzo (e.g. v Psakhis in the 1981 USSR Championship) he has tended to lose.

4	e3	0-0
5	♗d3	c5
6	♘f3	d5
7	0-0	dc
8	♗xc4	cd
9	ed	b6
10	♕e2	

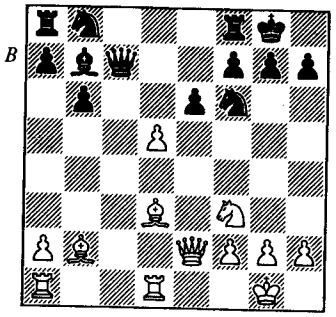
A sharp idea which often involves sacrificing a pawn on c3.

10	...	♗b7
11	♖d1	♗xc3
12	bc	♕c7
13	♗d3	♕xc3?!

Too greedy. Either 13 ... ♘d5 or 13 ... ♘bd7 should have been played.

14	♗b2	♕c7
15	d5!!	

A violent second pawn sacrifice, which Kasparov may have overlooked or underestimated when grabbing the hot c-pawn on move



13. In fact, this game exposes Gary's two main weaknesses: overconfidence plus not feeling fully comfortable in heavy defensive positions.

15	...	♗xd5

If 15 ... ♘xd5 White has three tempting continuations: 16 ♕e4 ♘f6 17 ♕h4, 16 ♗xh7+ ♔xh7 17 ♘g5+ or simply 16 ♘g5.

16	♗xf6	gf
17	♕e3!	

Threatening to win with ♕h6.

17	...	♔g7
18	♖ac1	♘c6
19	♗e4?	

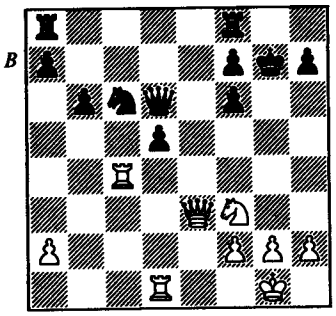
Letting the win slip. After 19 ♘d4 ♖fd8 20 ♗b5 ♕b7 (forced) 21 ♕g3+ ♔f8 22 ♗xc6 ♗xc6 23 ♕f4! f5 24 ♖e1 White has a decisive attack.

19	...	♕d6!
20	♗xd5	ed
21	♖c4	

diagram

21	...	♕d7?

It is Black's turn to go wrong. After 21 . . ♘e7 22 ♖h4 ♘f5 23 ♖g4+ ♔h8 24 ♕d3 ♘e7 he has



weathered the assault and stands better.

22	♖h4	♕f5
23	♖xd5	♘e5
24	h3	♖fe8
25	♘d4	♕g6
26	♕f4	♖ad8
27	♘f5+	♔h8
28	♖xd8	♖xd8
29	♕e4	♖c8?

29 ... ♕g8 30 ♘e7 ♕g7 was still satisfactory.

30	♔h2	♖c4?!
31	♕a8+	♕g8
32	♕xa7	♖xh4
33	♘xh4	♕g5
34	♕a8+	♔g7
35	♕e4	h5??

The final blunder, but White stood much better after 35 ... ♘g6 36 ♘f5+ ♔g8 37 g3.

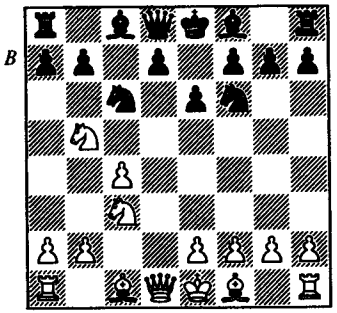
36	♘f5+	♔g6
37	♘e7+	♔h6
38	f4	

1-0

Here is Korchnoi's best game from his Candidates' Quarter-Final against Portisch.

Korchnoi-Portisch
Match (3) Bad Kissingen 1983
English Opening

1	c4	c5
2	♘f3	♘c6
3	♘c3	♘f6
4	d4	cd
5	♘xd4	e6
6	♘db5	



At this juncture Korchnoi used to favour 6 g3. The text leads by force to early simplification, but Korchnoi was never one to back away from the endgame. In fact, as Karpov discovered in games 28, 29 and 31 at Baguio, Korchnoi positively revels in starkly simplified positions.

6	...	d5
7	♗f4	e5
8	cd	ef
9	dc	bc
10	♕xd8+	♔xd8
11	♘d4	

A refined new idea. Normally White seeks to gain a development tempo with 11 ♖d1+ or 11 0-0-0+, but Korchnoi has seen that it can be of equal importance to gain

time by immediately threatening the pawn on c6. Furthermore, White's king may turn out to be more secure on the king's wing, than on c1.

11 ... ♔c7

A more efficient formation can be introduced with 11 ... ♗d7, e.g. 12 g3 ♗d6 13 ♗g2 ♖c8 14 0-0 ♔e7!

12 g3 ♗c5?!

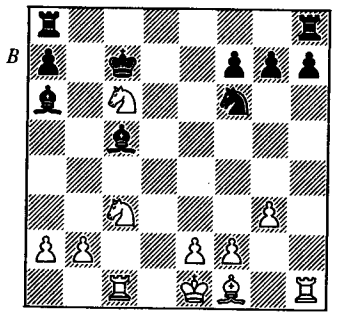
Asking for trouble on the c-file, where Black is concentrating too many sensitive units. Best is 12 ... ♗b4 followed by ... ♗xc3.

13 ♖c1! fg

14 hg ♗a6

The last chance is 14 ... ♖b8! 15 ♘b3 ♗b4 16 ♗g2 ♗e6, just ±. Now Korchnoi blows Portisch up with a vigorous combinative explosion, all the more impressive since queens have been exchanged.

15 ♘xc6!



15 ... ♗b7

16 ♘a4!

Accurate. Not 16 ♗g2? ♗xc6 17 ♗xc6 ♗xf2+ 18 ♔xf2 ♘g4+.

16 ... ♗xf2+

17 ♔xf2 ♘e4+

18 ♔g1 ♗xc6

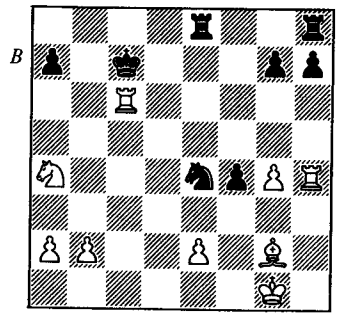
19 ♗g2 ♖ae8

Or 19 ... f5 20 g4 g6 21 gf gf 22 ♖h6 winning.

20 ♖h4 f5

21 g4 f4

22 ♖xc6+!



The final blow, which completes the undermining of Black's structure and reaps a decisive material advantage. The rest is easy to understand.

22 ... ♔xc6

23 ♘c3 ♔c5

24 ♗xe4 ♔d4

25 ♗f3 ♖b8

26 ♘a4 ♖b4

27 ♖h5 ♖d8

28 b3 h6

29 ♔f2 ♖d6

30 ♖f5 g5

31 ♖f7 ♔e5

32 ♖xa7 ♖d2

33 ♘c5 ♖bd4

34 ♖a6 ♖d6

35 ♖a5

1-0

An elegant filigree performance by Korchnoi.

NIKSIC 1983

	rating 1.7.83	*K*	*L*	*P*	*S*	*A*	*M*	*T*	*T*	*L*	*S*	*G*	*P*	*N*	*S*	*I*	*total*	*place*
G.Kasparov	2690	■	1	1	0	½	½	½	1	1	1	1	1	1	½	1	**11**	1
B.Larsen	2565	0	■	½	½	1	0	½	1	½	1	1	½	½	1	1	**9**	2
L.Portisch	2600	0	½	■	½	½	½	½	½	½	0	½	1	1	1	1	**8**	3 =
B.Spassky	2605	1	½	½	■	½	½	½	½	½	0	½	½	1	½	1	**8**	3 =
U.Andersson	2640	½	0	½	½	■	1	½	½	½	½	0	1	1	½	½	**7½**	5 =
A.Miles	2585	½	1	½	½	0	■	0	½	1	½	½	½	½	1	½	**7½**	5 =
M.Tal	2620	½	½	½	½	½	1	■	½	½	0	½	½	½	½	½	**7**	7 =
J.Timman	2605	0	0	½	½	½	½	½	■	1	½	1	½	½	½	½	**7**	7 =
L.Ljubojević	2645	0	½	½	½	½	0	½	0	■	1	½	0	½	1	1	**6½**	9 =
Y.Seirawan	2605	0	0	1	1	½	½	1	½	0	■	½	½	0	0	1	**6½**	9 =
S.Gligorić	2505	0	0	½	½	1	½	½	0	½	½	■	½	½	½	½	**6**	11 =
T.Petrosian	2580	0	½	0	½	0	½	½	½	1	½	½	■	½	½	½	**6**	11 =
P.Nikolić	2530	0	½	0	0	0	½	½	½	½	1	½	½	■	½	½	**5½**	13
G.Sax	2570	½	0	0	½	½	0	½	½	0	1	½	½	½	■	0	**5**	14
B.Ivanović	2490	0	0	0	0	½	½	½	½	0	0	½	½	½	1	■	**4½**	15

'One Big Punch'

(Viktor Korchnoi on the style of Gary Kasparov)

The Nikšić tournament is of interest as Gary's last triumph before London. The notes to the following game are Kasparov's own, reprinted by kind permission of Bob Wade from his book *Nikšić 1983.*

Kasparov-Portisch
Nikšić 1983
Queen's Indian Defence

1 d4 ♘f6

2 c4 e6

3 ♘f3 b6

4 ♘c3 ♗b7

5 a3 d5

6 cd ♘xd5

7 e3 ♘xc3

8 bc ♗e7

9 ♗b5+ c6

10 ♗d3 c5

11 0-0 ♘c6

12 ♗b2 ♖c8

13 ♕e2 0-0

14 ♖ad1 ♕c7?!

14 ... cd 15 cd ♗f6 16 e4 ♘xd4?! 17 ♗xd4 ♗xd4 18 ♗b5! gave White a big advantage in Gligorić-Liang Jinrong, Lucerne Ol 1982.

15 c4!

New! 15 e4 ♘a5 16 ♖fe1 ½-½ was Polugayevsky-Portisch, Plovdiv 1983.

15 ... cd

If immediately 15 ... ♘a5 16 d5! ed 17 cd c4 (17 ... ♗xd5 18 ♗xh7+) 18 ♗f5 ♖cd8 19 e4 gives White a big advantage, while after 15 ... ♗f6? 16 d5 ♘e5 17 ♘xe5 ♗xe5 18 ♗xh7+ White wins a pawn.

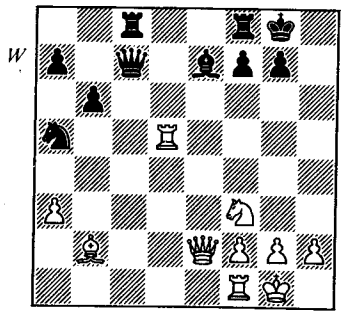
16 ed ♘a5

17 d5! ed

On 17 ... ♘xc4 the variation 18 ♕e4! g6 19 ♗xc4 ♕xc4 20 ♕e5 f6 21 ♕xe6+ ♖f7 22 ♖c1 ♕a6 23 d6 ♖xc1 24 ♖xc1 ♗d8 25 ♘g5! fg 26 ♖c7!! ♗xc7 27 ♕e8+ ♖f8 28 ♕e5 is winning for White.

18 cd ♗xd5
19 ♗xh7+ ♔xh7
20 ♖xd5 ♔g8

If 20 ... ♕c2 White wins by 21 ♖d2!, e.g. 21 ... ♕c5 22 ♘e5!



21 ♗xg7!!

If 21 ♘g5 ♕c2.

21 ... ♔xg7
22 ♘e5! ♖fd8

The best chance. Instead if:

a) **22 ... ♕c2** 23 ♕g4+ ♔h7 24 ♖d3 ♖c6 25 ♕f5+!

b) **22 ... ♖h8** 23 ♕g4+ ♔f8 24 ♕f5 f6 25 ♖e1! ♕c2 (25 ... ♘c6 26 ♘d7+ ♔f7 27 ♖xe7+!) 26 ♖d3,

c) **22 ... ♖cd8** 23 ♕g4+ ♔h7 24 ♘d7! and

d) **22 ... f5** 23 ♖d7 ♕c5 24 ♘d3 all win for White.

23 ♕g4+ ♔f8
24 ♕f5!

Better than 24 ♘d7+ ♖xd7 25 ♖xd7 ♕e5 (±).

24 ... f6

After 24 ... ♗d6 25 ♕f6 continues White's attack, e.g:

a) **25 ... ♔g8** 26 ♕g5+ ♔f8 27 ♕h6+ ♔g8 (27 ... ♔e8 28 ♖e1) 28 ♘g4!

b) **25 ... ♘c4** 26 ♘g6+ ♔e8 27 ♖e1+ ♔d7 28 ♖e7+ winning Black's queen and leading to a pawn advance on the kingside.

25 ♘d7+

Not 25 ♘g6+? ♔g7 (25 ... ♔e8? 26 ♕h5!! ♖xd5 27 ♘e5+ and mates) 26 ♘f4 ♖xd5 27 ♕g6+ ♔h8 and draws (but not 28 ♕h6+ ♔g8 29 ♘e6 ♖g5!).

25 ... ♖xd7
26 ♖xd7 ♕c5
27 ♕h7 ♖c7
28 ♕h8+!

Not 28 ♖d3? allowing 28 ... ♕xf2+!! 29 ♔xf2 (29 ♖xf2? ♖c1+ and Black mates) 29 ... ♗c5+ 30 ♔g3 ♖xh7 =.

28 ... ♔f7
29 ♖d3 ♘c4
30 ♖fd1! ♘e5?

Loses outright. 30 ... ♗d6! offers better resistance: after 31 **♖d5!** ♕c6 (31 ... ♕xa3 loses to 32 ♖xd6 ♘xd6 33 ♕h7+ and 34 ♕xc7) 32 h4 White retains good winning chances.

31 ♕h7+ ♔e6

If 31 ... ♔f8 32 ♖d8+ wins.

32 ♕g8+ ♔f5
33 g4+! ♔f4
34 ♖d4+ ♔f3
35 ♕b3+

1-0

If 35 ... ♕c3 36 ♕d5+.

eight
BEFORE THE START

So many times during the fight to secure the Championship for England, I came across the objection, 'it's impossible', 'can't be done in the time' etc. To be fair, this was not a wholly unreasonable or untenable point of view. It should not be forgotten that on 16 October, just after my return from the Manila FIDE Congress, I had no particular sponsor in mind at all, while on 21 November, Korchnoi and Kasparov sat down to play their first game! One potential stumbling block was the venue. When Stewart Reuben, the BCF Congress Director, rang the London Convention Advisory Bureau for help in locating a playing hall in November, he was greeted with the jovial comment: 'Of course you do mean November 1984'. The problem was solved in an original way. My co-author to be, Dominic Lawson, inserted a piece on the forthcoming match in the 'Men and Matters' column of the *Financial Times*, ending on a thinly veiled plea for someone to volunteer a venue. This succeeded brilliantly, since Shandwicks, the publicity consultants of the Great Eastern Hotel, spotted a marvellous opportunity for the vacant Banqueting Hall of their Hotel. They immediately contacted the BCF Publicity Officer, Jim Timperley, and thus we were introduced to the Great Eastern Hotel and its General Manager, Arnot Wilson, who were to be our hosts for the duration of the contest.

Few chess events in the UK can have received the advance fanfare achieved by this semi-final: furious Soviet diplomatic activity, a *Times* leader (reproduced overleaf) and finally the opening reception at 11 Downing Street (for the benefit of foreign readers, the official residence of the Chancellor of the Exchequer, the British Finance Minister).

CHESSBOARD DIPLOMACY

It is rare for negotiations between the West and Russia to end in agreement, with a crisis resolved, everyone behaving reasonably and sweetness and light spread around. But this has happened in the chess world, and it ought to be more widely celebrated. What is more, Britons, who may have been feeling brushed aside this week, can take pride in the leading role their representatives played; and the upshot is that London will this month see a feast of top-class chess.

Trouble arose over the siting of the two semi-final matches of the series which is to produce a challenger next year to the world chess champion. The president of the International Chess Federation, Mr Florencio Campomanes of the Philippines, decided that one should be played in Pasadena, California, and one in Abu Dhabi. He was moved by the huge prize money offered, as well as generous donations to help the developing world. The Russians refused to send their players to either site: one was too distracting, the other too hot. Increasingly vituperative debate failed to move Mr Campomanes and he finally declared both matches forfeit to the Russians' opponents.

This created an impossible situation. The world championship system and the whole organization of world chess was at risk. Chess enthusiasts were particularly upset because the Pasadena match was to have been between Gary Kasparov, at 20 a shining new star in the Russian firmament, and Victor Korchnoi, aged 52, émigré and often abusively anti-Soviet grandmaster who now plays for Switzerland. This promised headlines as well as chess brilliancy.

A way out of the impasse became visible because of an initiative by the players themselves. Korchnoi and Kasparov happened to meet in Yugoslavia in August and they addressed a joint letter to the International Chess Federation saying they wanted to play their match rather than have a result by default. There was also intense diplomatic activity, with England's representative, Raymond Keene, travelling to Moscow and drafting compromise proposals.

Things came to a head at the annual meeting of the international federation in Manila on October 1. There peace broke out on all sides. The Russians ceased their bitter criticism of Mr Campomanes, Korchnoi softened his demand that the Russians apologize and cease to boycott tournaments in which he played, and Britain (thanks to about £80,000 from Acorn Computers) was able to offer a site and a reasonable prize fund. The result is that both the Korchnoi-Kasparov match and the other semi-final, between Zoltan Ribli of Hungary and Vasily Smyslov of the Soviet Union, will be played at the Great Eastern Hotel, London, from November 21.

Chess players are often tempted to think that some deep significance attaches to their efforts across the board. There is intense intellectual effort, a subtle and artistic marshalling of forces, the overthrow of kings, intrigue of queens. It is all confined to a game, even if the greatest. But there is a wider significance in the way the chess leaders have resolved their differences in the negotiating chamber. Political leaders, in the world where blood flows when a pawn is taken, could learn a lesson.

game one
GRIM REAPER

turned in a smoothly 'Karpovian' technical achievement to take a surprise 1-0 lead, with Black, in the inaugural game. The Soviet prodigy's opening move was made by Tim Rice (of *Evita*, *Jesus Christ Superstar* and *Blondel* fame) amidst Acorn designer John Caswell's futuristic staging, described in the Soviet Press as resembling an 'aviary'. In spite of opening with his favourite a3 line against the Queen's Indian Defence, Kasparov could not avoid a gradual slide downhill into an inferior and ultimately lost ending. It was remarkable that the young Russian had consumed alomst all of his time allowance of 2½ hours by move 24, while Korchnoi had only used up one hour and continued moving rapidly until the end. This was a remarkable triumph for the 52-year-old veteran against an opponent who should have been bursting with youthful energy. Incidentally, the 'aviary' which surrounded the players, and the whole set-up in the hall featuring Acorn heraldic banners and computer monitors, had been constructed in one swift blitz by Caswell and his expert crew, starting at 3.00 am on 21 November ready for a 16.00 hrs kick-off. The Hamilton Hall had been previously booked by a religious group, which stubbornly refused to vacate the premises until the last possible moment.

In the games which follow, the times used by the players have been recorded in hours and minutes. Retention of this information is regarded as particularly valuable for timing purposes and self-examination, and has been recommended by experts such as David Bronstein and Bob Wade. It should be remembered that if either player has not completed 40 moves by the time his clock registers 2.30, he loses by time forfeit. All further batches of 16 moves must be completed in one-hour periods; thus move 56 must be attained before the player's clock reads 3.30. It is clear that reproduction of times used is an

integral part of the struggle and obviously helps to recreate the tense in-play atmosphere.

Kasparov-Korchnoi
Game 1, 21/11/83
Queen's Indian Defence

1	**d4**	*0.00*	**♘f6**	*0.00*
2	**c4**	*0.00*	**e6**	
3	**♘f3**	*0.01*		

Inviting the solid Queen's Indian Defence, a line which Kasparov appears to relish challenging. In their second game from the Blitz tournament at Herceg Novi in September of this year, Gary, as White v Korchnoi, actually allowed the Nimzo-Indian Defence with 3 ♘c3 and after 3 ... ♗b4 4 e3 0-0 5 a3 ♗xc3+ 6 bc d6 7 ♗d3 e5 8 e4 c5 9 ♘e2 ♘c6 10 0-0 ♗g4?! 11 f3 ♗h5 12 d5 ♘a5 13 g4 ♗g6 14 h4 White had a great advantage and went on to win easily. Doubtless Korchnoi had prepared for this line and had an improvement in mind should Kasparov have chanced repeating it, e.g. 10 ... cd 11 cd ed 12 ♗b2 ♖e8. For the full game see 'Previous Encounters'.

3	...		**b6**	*0.00*
4	**♘c3**	*0.01*	**♗b7**	*0.00*

After 4 ... ♗b4 Kasparov likes the two-bishop position arising from 5 ♕c2 ♗b7 6 a3.

5	**a3**	*0.05*		

5 a3 is known as the Petrosian variation, but it has become Kasparov's potent patent.

5	...		**d5**	*0.00*
6	**cd**	*0.05*	**♘xd5**	*0.00*
7	**e3**	*0.13*		

The fashionable line, though Kasparov has also tried 7 ♕c2.

7	...		**g6!?**	*0.00*

US Grandmaster Jim Tarjan writes of this move: 'a noteworthy alternative to 7 ... ♗e7, which gets smashed with alarming regularity'.

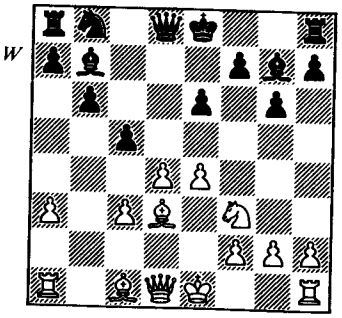
8	**♗b5+**	*0.26*		

Timman-Short, London (Phillips & Drew) 1982, went: 8 ♘xd5 ♕xd5 9 ♕c2 ♕d8 10 e4 ♗g7 11 ♗g5 ♕d7 12 ♗c4 with more pleasant prospects for White. Perhaps Kasparov should have modelled his play on this example.

8	...		**c6**	*0.01*
9	**♗d3**	*0.29*	**♗g7**	*0.01*
10	**e4**	*0.30*		

Kasparov starts to establish the big pawn centre, which has brought him many notable victories. Less ambitious, but more enduring, is 10 0-0, e.g. 10 ... 0-0 11 ♘xd5 (this motif again) 11 ... cd 12 ♗d2 ♘c6 13 ♖c1 with a slight edge to White.

10	...		**♘xc3**	*0.01*
11	**bc**	*0.30*	**c5**	*0.01*



Now White should probably try 12 ♗b5+ ♗c6 13 ♗xc6+ ♘xc6 14 ♗e3, or 12 0-0 ♘c6 13 ♗e3 0-0 14 e5 as given by Ftacnik in his notes to the game Ftacnik-Adorjan, Banja Luka 1983. Another idea is 14 ♗b1 followed by ♖a2.

12	**♗g5**	*0.48*	**♕d6**	*0.02*
13	**e5**	*1.20*		

Essentially the same as Ftacnik's idea, controlling dark squares around Black's king, though the move obviously has some positional drawbacks, such as weakening the a8-h1 diagonal and depriving White's pawn centre of its flexibility.

13	...		**♕d7**	*0.02*
14	**dc**	*1.24*		

As we can see, after this move Kasparov had taken over 1 hour and 20 minutes, while Korchnoi had consumed a mere two minutes! This comparison is a sure indication that White was not satisfied with his position. 14 0-0 looks sensible.

14	...		**0-0**	*0.02*

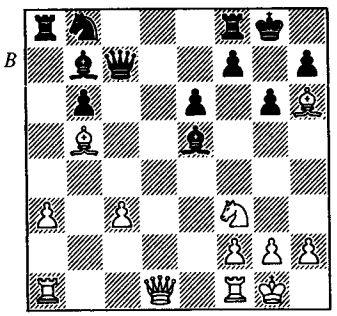
Black can safely sacrifice one pawn since White's remaining pawns are so scattered.

15	**cb**	*1.27*	**ab**	*0.02*

This is now very similar to positions which may arise from a Grünfeld Defence.

16	**0-0**	*1.29*	**♕c7**	*0.04*
17	**♗b5**	*1.55*	**♗xe5**	*0.53*
18	**♗h6**	*1.57*		

Not 18 ♘xe5? ♕xe5 forking b5 and g5.



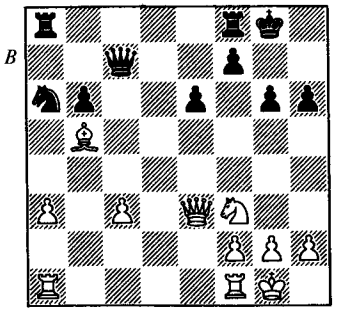
18	...		**♗g7**	*1.05*

Safety first. Great speculation in the Press Room here as to the soundness of 18 ... ♖d8 19 ♘xe5!? ♖xd1 20 ♖axd1, with unclear compensation for the queen sacrificed. There is no necessity for Black to run such risks.

19	**♗xg7**	*1.57*	**♔xg7**	*1.05*
20	**♕d4+**	*2.01*	**♔g8**	*1.05*
21	**♘g5**	*2.05*	**h6**	*1.06*
22	**♘e4**	*2.06*	**♗xe4**	*1.06*

He must eliminate this piece before it develops aggressive potential.

23	**♕xe4**	*2.07*	**♘a6**	*1.06*
24	**♕e3?**	*2.24*		



Probably in a higher sense, the decisive error. Kasparov invested 16 minutes in this oversight and now had only six minutes left to reach move 40, while Korchnoi still held a further 80 minutes in reserve. White's only chance is to seek salvation in a major piece ending after 24 ♗xa6! ♖xa6 25 ♕b4. In that case, the worst that could befall White is loss of his a- and c-pawns for Black's b-pawn. The likely outcome would be reduction to a rook and pawn ending of four pawns to three, all on the kingside. Advantage to Black, but a theoretical draw. The move chosen with a threat to h6, overlooked that Black can force a vastly favourable exchange of queens.

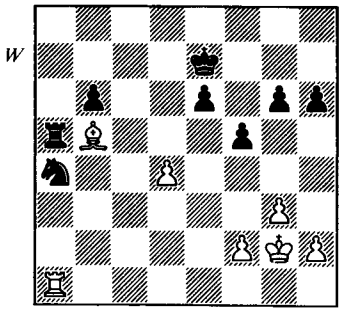
24	...		**♕c5!**	*1.08*
25	**♕xc5**	*2.25*	**♘xc5**	*1.08*

White has split pawns and no real counterplay. The kind of position Korchnoi can handle to perfection.

26	**♖fb1**	*2.25*	**♖fd8**	*1.11*
27	**♗f1**	*2.25*	**♖d6**	*1.11*
28	**♖b4**	*2.26*	**♔f8**	*1.13*
29	**a4**	*2.26*	**♖a5**	*1.15*
30	**g3**	*2.27*	**♔e7**	*1.15*
31	**♔g2**	*2.27*	**f5**	*1.16*
32	**♗b5**	*2.28*	**♖d2**	*1.17*
33	**♖d4**	*2.28*		

Black was threatening ... e5-e4 and ... ♘e4. White has little choice.

33	...		**♖xd4**	*1.18*
34	**cd**	*2.28*	**♘xa4!**	*1.18*



A neat tactical trick which ensures a decisive advantage.

35	**♖xa4**	*2.29*		

Or 35 ♗xa4 b5!

35	...		**♖xb5**	*1.18*

With a passed extra pawn, the rest needs no comment.

36	**♖a7+**	*2.29*	**♔d6**	*1.19*
37	**♖h7**	*2.29*	**h5**	*1.19*
38	**♖g7**	*2.29*	**♖d5**	*1.20*
39	**♖xg6**	*2.29*	**b5**	*1.21*
40	**♔f3**	*2.29*	**b4**	*1.34*
41	**♔e3**	*2.30*	**b3**	*1.34*
42	**♔d2**	*2.31*	**♖xd4+**	*1.34*
43	**♔c3**	*2.31*	**b2**	*1.34*
44	**♔xb2**	*2.31*	**♖d2+**	*1.34*
45	**♔c3**	*2.32*	**♖xf2**	*1.34*
46	**h4**	*2.33*	**f4**	*1.42*
47	**♖g5**	*2.34*	**♖f3+**	*1.43*
48	**♔d4**	*2.34*	**♖xg3**	*1.45*
49	**♖xh5**	*2.35*	**♖e3**	*1.46*
50	**♖h6**	*2.35*	**♔e7**	*1.46*
51	**h5**	*2.36*	**e5+**	*1.47*
52	**♔d5**	*2.36*	**f3**	*1.47*

White resigned

Korchnoi received a thunderous ovation.

Since Kasparov has virtually made a living out of his theoretical

preparation in the a3 line of the Queen's Indian (see, for example, his games with Murei, Gheorghiu and Portisch in Chapter 7), the result of this game must have come as a bitter blow. Not only was Korchnoi well prepared, he also exploited this fact to move rapidly and avoid any hint of the time trouble which often plagues him. All in all, the young aspirant was totally outplayed in all stages.

game two
MAN THE BARRICADES!

No sign yet of any desire for revenge on Kasparov's part today, just dour defence to regain his balance after the shock defeat in Game 1. At the close of play, Black even seemed to have somewhat the better chances, but Gary decided to open his account with half a point, rather than risk going for more. Perhaps jet-lag after his arduous journey from Baku on 18 November had something to do with this as well.

As I mention in my notes, Gary has frequently been described as the chess heir of Alekhine, yet his cautious, solid approach here reminds me more of Capablanca, who, by the way, often resorted to main lines of the Tarrasch Defence.

Korchnoi-Kasparov
Game 2, 23/11/83
Tarrasch Defence

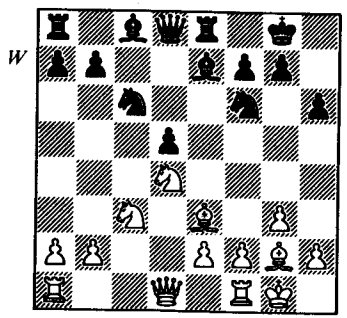
1	**d4**	*0.00*	**d5**	*0.00*
2	**c4**	*0.00*	**e6**	*0.00*
3	**♘c3**	*0.00*	**c5**	*0.00*

The Tarrasch is no longer a surprise from Gary, though not so long ago the King's Indian would have been obligatory.

4	**cd**	*0.00*	**ed**	*0.00*

Alekhine, who is often cited as Kasparov's model, once tried the gambit line 4 ... cd here. I wonder whether his spiritual protégé will ever embrace it too. Pirc-Alekhine, Bled 1931, went: 4 ... cd 5 ♕a4+ ♗d7 6 ♕xd4 ed 7 ♕xd5 ♘c6 8 ♗g5?! ♘f6 9 ♕d2 h6 10 ♗xf6 ♕xf6 11 e3 0-0-0 12 0-0-0 ♗g4 13 ♘d5 ♖xd5 14 ♕xd5 ♗a3! with a crushing attack. Since then, better methods have been elaborated for White, but the gambit has never been definitively refuted.

5	**♘f3**	*0.00*	**♘c6**	*0.00*
6	**g3**	*0.01*	**♘f6**	*0.01*
7	**♗g2**	*0.01*	**♗e7**	*0.01*
8	**0-0**	*0.01*	**0-0**	*0.01*
9	**♗g5**	*0.01*	**cd**	*0.01*
10	**♘xd4**	*0.01*	**h6**	*0.01*
11	**♗e3**	*0.01*	**♖e8**	*0.02*

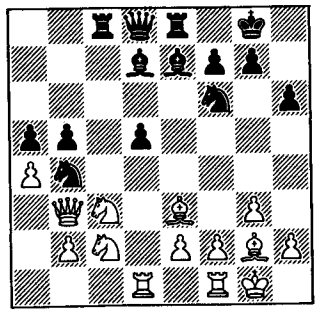


12	**a3!?**	*0.02*		

Eric Schiller, who is running the Press Room here, tells me that this is a theoretical novelty. Eric is currently involved in writing a book on the increasingly popular Tarrasch, so he should know. One of the points of 12 a3 must be to follow up with ♕b3 (menacing d5) and then drop back with the queen to a2, in case it is bothered by ... ♘a5. Kasparov has had two other celebrated wins using the position after 11 ... ♖e8 as their point of departure:

a) Belyavsky-Kasparov, Moscow (2nd Match Game) 1983 – 12 ♕a4 ♗d7 13 ♖ad1 ♘b4 14 ♕b3 a5 15 ♖d2 a4, with great Black activity.

b) Korchnoi-Kasparov, Herceg Novi (Blitz) 1983 – 12 ♕a4 ♗d7 13 ♖ad1 ♘b4 14 ♕b3 a5 15 a4 (widely recommended as an improvement on the Belyavsky game) 15 ... ♖c8 16 ♘c2 b5!



A new move. 17 ♘xb4 ba 18 ♘xa4 ♗xb4 19 ♘b6 (looks natural, but . . .) 19 ... ♖xe3! 20 ♕xe3 ♗c5 21 ♘xd7 ♗xe3 22 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 23 fe ♕xb2 24 ♗xd5. Here Black should try 24 ... ♕xe2, with good winning chances, but he went astray with 24 ... ♖c7? allowing 25 ♗xf7+ ♔h7 26 ♖d6 ♖xf7 27 ♖xf7 ♕xe2. The excitement is over and the position should now be drawn, since White can blockade with his rooks along the second rank. In fact Korchnoi, in desperate time trouble, eventually blundered away one of his rooks to a queen check, but my agents in Herceg Novi failed to keep pace with the lightning conclusion of the game. Having seen this, I can't help asking myself if it was wise policy on Kasparov's part to reveal his own 16th move theoretical novelty in advance in a blitz game.

12	**...**		**♗e6**	*0.42*

A safe move, rather than striking out with ... ♗g4. Confronted with Korchnoi's home-brewed invention, Kasparov used up 40 minutes here.

13	**♕b3**	*0.03*	**♕d7**	*0.49*
14	**♘xe6**	*0.17*	**fe**	*0.50*

White gains the two bishops, but strengthens Black's pawn centre.

15	**♖ad1**	*0.18*	**♗d6**	*1.08*
16	**♗c1**	*0.30*		

To hit out with e4.

16	**...**		**♔h8**	*1.10*

Security measures. It is very uncomfortable to have Black's king aligned with the queen on b3.

17	**♕a4**	*0.37*	**♕e7**	*1.28*

18	**e3**	*0.40*	**a6**	*1.35*
19	**♕h4**	*0.45*	**♖ac8**	*1.46*

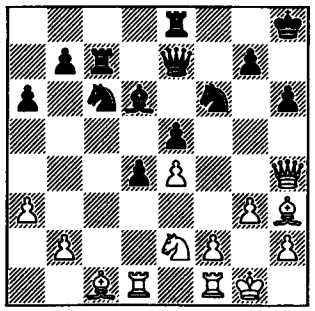
As can be seen from the clock times, Viktor has certainly been undermining his own reputation as a time-trouble artiste in the games so far.

20	**e4**	*0.48*	**d4**	*1.47*
21	**♘e2**	*0.48*	**e5**	*1.50*
22	**♗h3**	*1.16*		

Viktor had a long think over this one, but the plan he now adopts fails to preserve the initiative.

22	**...**		**♖c7**	*1.56*

W



23	**♗g5**	*1.17*		

A superficial glance might suggest that White can sacrifice with ♗xh6 at some point, but after 23 ♗xh6 gh 24 ♕xh6+ ♔g8 Black will soon repulse boarders with ... ♕g7, solving all problems.

23	**...**		**♔g8**	*1.59*
24	**♗xf6**	*1.17*	**♕xf6**	*1.59*
25	**♕xf6**	*1.18*	**gf**	*1.59*
26	**♘c1**	*1.25*	**♘a5**	*2.01*
27	**♘d3**	*1.25*	**♘b3**	*2.02*

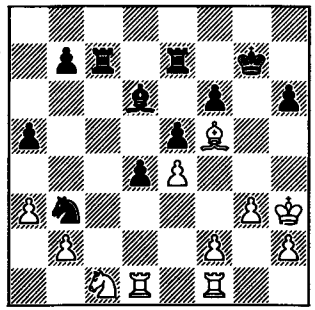
Now White cannot occupy the c-file with a rook; meanwhile, Black gains time to use c7 as a springboard for c-file operations.

28	**♗f5**	*1.31*	**a5**	*2.05*
29	**♔g2**	*1.34*		

29 f4 is more active, but does it achieve much if Black sits tight?

29	**...**		**♔g7**	*2.06*
30	**♔h3**	*1.34*	**♖ee7**	*2.08*
31	**♘c1**			

B



Korchnoi now offered a draw, which Kasparov accepted. An understandable decision given the débâcle of Game 1, but after 31 ... ♘c5 the feeling was that Black enjoys a slight edge. On the other hand, 31 ...a4 achieves less than nothing after 32 ♘xb3 ab 33 ♖d3 annexing the far-flung b-pawn.

This game, and those that followed, were transmitted live, move by move, to Reykjavik, Dubai, New York and ten separate lecture halls in Buenos Aires, where (according to Najdorf), amongst others, Grandmasters Panno, Larsen and Quinteros were commenting.

game three
ALL QUIET ON THE (GREAT) EASTERN FRONT

Global interest in the match is shown by more than 100 chess journalists and distinguished ex-players who have come from everywhere to report and watch. Walking into the Press Room is like entering a time capsule of post-war tournaments. The legendary veteran Miguel Najdorf from Buenos Aires, still a great player at 73, Robert Byrne of the US, Yuri Averbakh the Moscow grandmaster and endgame writer, Roman Toran from Spain, all are there. To watch Najdorf dissect a game in progress is a chess education in itself.

Leonard Barden, *Financial Times*

Actually, the total press corps had swollen to well over 200 as we moved deeper into the match. Many of these are high class chess 'groupies', who rarely leave the thud and blunder of the Press Room, infinitely preferring this kind of direct action to the relative tranquility of watching the games live. Grandmasters such as Byrne and Najdorf globetrot from event to event – as Dominic said to me, for them the world is just one big chess analysis room.

Every chess journalist would like to see some off-board action during great chess contests, to help spice up the often purely technical angle of their reports. The World Championship at Baguio 1978 was particularly rich in this respect (yoghurt, para-psychologists, Ananda Marga ...) while Merano 1981 also had its fair share of incidents. Here in London, however, the atmosphere is serene and the Arbiters and Jury Chairman can be observed each day relaxing in the front row, with no hint of any disturbance to upset their enjoyment of the games. As if overcome by this peaceful atmosphere, the two matadors, Kasparov and Korchnoi, also concluded an early cease-fire. They were seen together amicably analysing after the game, a sure indication of the high regard they have for each other's skills and sportsmanship. After all, without

the players' co-operation, in particular that of Zoltan Ribli and Viktor Korchnoi, these events could never have taken place in London.

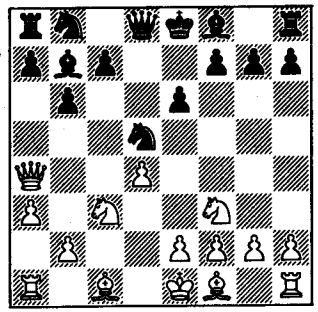
Kasparov-Korchnoi
Game 3, 25/11/83
Queen's Indian Defence

1	**d4**	*0.00*	**♘f6**	*0.00*
2	**c4**	*0.00*	**e6**	*0.00*
3	**♘f3**	*0.00*		

When, if ever, will Kasparov venture 3 ♘c3?

3	**...**		**b6**	*0.00*
4	**♘c3**	*0.00*	**♗b7**	*0.00*
5	**a3**	*0.00*	**d5**	*0.00*
6	**cd**	*0.00*	**♘xd5**	*0.00*
7	**♕a4+**	*0.00*		

B



An unequivocal indication that Kasparov was not fully content with the outcome of the opening from Game 1. The point of the queen check is to encourage certain pawn weaknesses in Black's queenside structure, but the entire concept strikes me as rather artificial and not particularly in Kasparov's style. For example, it already virtually rules out the central pawn avalanche which has been a feature of so many of Kasparov's wins with a3 against the Queen's Indian.

7	**...**		**♘d7**	*0.09*
8	**♘xd5**	*0.00*	**ed**	*0.09*
9	**♗f4**	*0.02*	**c6**	*0.18*
10	**g3**	*0.38*		

It is curious to note the time consumed by Kasparov over this move. We must assume that 7 ♕a4+ was a prepared line, so why waste so much time on this natural decision – one which surely should have been investigated and taken before the game. After all, Korchnoi's reply to 7 ♕a4+ has scarcely been unconventional.

10	**...**		**♗e7**	*0.19*
11	**♗h3**	*0.41*		

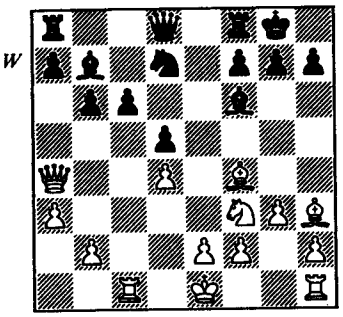
A more profitable diagonal for the bishop than merely reposing on g2; from h3 the white king's bishop discourages the black queen's rook from occupying its own logical post on c8. Now White's bishops apparently rake Black's queen-wing and the general opinion was that Kasparov held a tangible advantage.

11	**...**		**0-0**	*0.20*
12	**♖c1**	*0.47*		

The times show how worried Korchnoi must have felt at this moment. White is manifestly considering an exchange sacrifice against c6, which might eventually devour the whole of Black's central pawn chain.

12	**...**		**♗f6**	*1.03*

W



A good, calm move. Korchnoi had learnt how to handle similar positions from his experience of observing Spassky during their Candidates' Final at Belgrade, Dec 1977/Jan 1978. True, Spassky there had been in possession of the bishop pair, but otherwise the differences are not enormous. Korchnoi-Spassky, 11th Match Game: 1 c4 e6 2 ♘c3 d5 3 d4 ♗e7 4 ♘f3 ♘f6 5 ♗g5 h6 6 ♗h4 0-0 7 e3 b6 8 ♖c1 ♗b7 9 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 10 cd ed 11 b4 c6 12 ♗d3 ♖e8 13 0-0 ♘d7 14 ♕b3 ♘f8 followed by ... ♘e6.

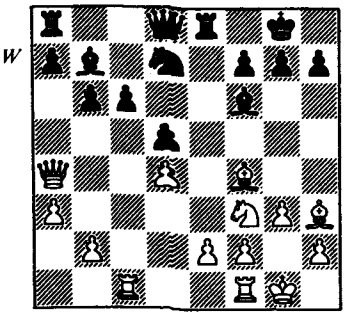
Interestingly, this extract is also strategically relevant to the handling of the queenless middlegame which follows in Game 6 of the London contest.

13	**0-0**	*0.54*		

According to Korchnoi, 13 ♖xc6 would have been more dangerous, e.g. 13 ... ♘c5 14 ♖xc5 bc 15 dc. If 14 dc? ♕e8! exploiting the pin (Byrne). Also, 13 ... g5, as proposed by Jury Chairman Sir Stuart Milner-Barry, is an idea. White's queen's bishop is then chased either from control of c7 or c1.

13	**...**		**♖e8**	*1.05*

W



Making way for the Spassky manoeuvre of ... ♘f8-e6.

14	**♖xc6**	*1.35*		

Gary must have been impatient to display some symbol of initiative in the match, but this sacrifice is still not one hundred per cent convincing. Alternatives are 14 ♖fe1 and 14 ♖c2, building up pressure on the c-file.

14	**...**		**♗xc6**	*1.05*

Now that White has castled and Black has blocked off e8 from his queen, neither of the Byrne and Milner-Barry antidotes is currently operative.

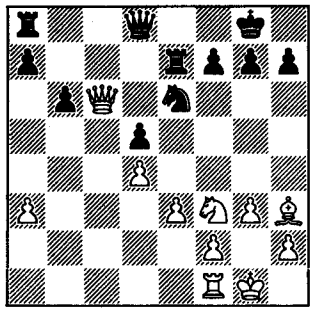
15	**♕xc6**	*1.35*	**♘f8**	*1.06*
16	**e3**	*1.36*	**♘e6**	*1.23*
17	**♗d6**	*1.38*	**♗e7**	*1.38*

Not 17 ... ♖c8 18 ♕xd5 ♗e7 19 ♗xe6!

18	**♗xe7**	*1.45*		

Kasparov made this capture and offered a draw which Korchnoi

accepted. A very disappointing conclusion to what had initially augured well as a fiercely contested struggle. 18 ♗e5 looks more combative. The real question is why were both players happy with a draw?



In the diagram I show the situation after Black's mandatory reply 18 ... ♖xe7. In *Chess Express*, an excellent new chess newspaper, the launch of which coincided with the opening of the London semis, Editor Jon Tisdall opined: 'A draw is an interesting psychological decision. Kasparov is apparently still regaining his confidence while Korchnoi is content to safely guard his lead. Or perhaps both players disliked their positions'.

Black certainly does not stand worse after 19 ♘e5 ♖c7 20 ♕b5 ♕d6 21 ♗g2 ♖d8 22 ♘d3, though Korchnoi may have felt he could not free himself sufficiently to make real progress. Still, with control of the only open file and a lead in the match, it is unlike him not to try. Anyway, Games 1 and 3 have drawn the teeth of Kasparov's feared anti-Queen's Indian system based on a3. This represents a major blow to Kasparov – has his 'one big punch' been neutralised?

game four
KILKENNY CATALAN

According to Jorge Luis Borges, the man who most deserves the Nobel Prize for literature, Kilkenny Cats 'got into raging quarrels and devoured each other, leaving behind them no more than their tails' (*The Book of Imaginary Beings*). In today's game a bitterly contested positional battle left no more than a rook each and a couple of pawns on the board. Although Kasparov racked his brains for a full 40 minutes over his sealed move, he could find nothing remotely advantageous, and peace was concluded next day. A few misdirected phone calls from Petra Leeuwerik conveying the truce offer initially missed their mark (i.e. Gligorić, the Chief Arbiter), but Jane Seymour from the Press Room eventually plucked up courage to take the draw offer directly to Kasparov. Actually, Gary should have been quite content with the outcome, since the opening left him with a notably weak c-pawn, while even the rook and knight endgame into which Viktor simplified still held some problems for Black.

Korchnoi-Kasparov
Game 4, 27/11/83
Catalan

1	**d4**	*0.00*	**d5**	*0.00*
2	**c4**	*0.00*	**e6**	*0.00*
3	**♘f3**	*0.00*	**♘f6**	*0.01*
4	**g3**	*0.00*		

Kasparov has never defended a Catalan in his life before this, but 4 ♘c3 or 4 ♗g5 would have left him in equally unfamiliar territory. After 4 ♘c3 c5 5 cd ed?! 6 ♗g5! leads to a line of the Tarrasch which is unfavourable for Black.

4	**...**		**♗e7**	*0.08*
5	**♗g2**	*0.01*	**0-0**	*0.08*
6	**0-0**	*0.01*	**dc**	*0.09*

Entering the popular main line of this defence. Black accepts a backward c-pawn in exchange for free development of his pieces.

7	**♕c2**	*0.01*	**a6**	*0.09*

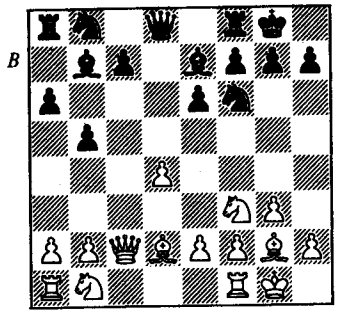
Presages an extended fianchetto with ... b5 plus ... ♗b7.

8	**♕xc4**	*0.01*

While I was functioning as Korchnoi's chief second at Baguio 1978, we spent a lot of energy examining 8 a4 ♘c6 9 ♕xc4 ♕d5 10 ♕d3 and 10 ♕c3!? but ultimately

we remained unimpressed. The weakness of the b4 square, often to be occupied by a black knight, can be most frustrating when White tries to make progress.

8	...		**b5**	*0.09*
9	**♕c2**	*0.02*	**♗b7**	*0.09*
10	**♗d2**	*0.16*		



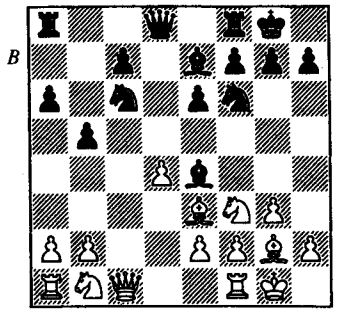
Threatens in some circumstances to travel to a5. This bishop move may appear restrained but leads to heavyweight positional battles where Black cannot afford any slips.

10	...		**♗e4**	*0.22*

Very interesting is 10 ... ♘c6 11 ♘c3 ♘xd4 12 ♘xd4 ♗xg2 13 ♘xe6! ♕c8! 14 ♘xf8 ♕h3 15 ♗g5 ♗xf1 16 ♖xf1 ♖xf8 17 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 18 ♘e4 ♕e6 19 b3 ♗e7, as occurred in the first game with this variation recorded by opening theory, namely Polugayevsky-Lengyel, Budapest 1964.

11	**♕c1**	*0.17*	**♘c6**	*1.04*
12	**♗e3**	*0.20*		

Times consumed at this point clearly demonstrate the relative familiarity of each player with the position. 12 ♗e3 is, in fact, part of



Korchnoi's pre-match preparation arsenal, as was confirmed by Lev Gutman, one of his seconds. It replaces the innocuous 12 e3 b4! of Sosonko-Gligorić, Lucerne Ol 1982.

12	...		**♘b4**	*1.12*

The first official 'new move'. The Chief Arbiter in London, Svetozar Gligorić, had fared badly as Black at Vrsac earlier this year with 12 ... ♖c8 13 ♘bd2 ♗d5 14 ♖d1 ♘g4 (loss in 47 v Agzamov) and 14 ... ♘a5 15 ♕c3 b4 16 ♕d3 (loss in 43 v Smejkal).

13	**♘bd2**	*0.50*	**♗b7**	*1.18*
14	**♗g5**	*0.59*	**♖c8**	*1.30*
15	**a3**	*1.02*	**♘bd5**	*1.31*
16	**♘b3**	*1.04*	**h6**	*1.32*
17	**♘a5**	*1.13*		

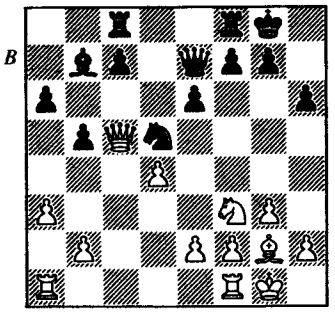
Introducing an ingenious manoeuvre which may, however, be superfluous. The simple 17 ♗xf6 retains a grip over c5 and must be in White's favour.

17	...		**♗a8**	*1.33*
18	**♘c6**	*1.15*	**♗xc6**	*1.33*
19	**♗xf6**	*1.15*	**♗b7**	*1.38*

It looks more sensible to keep

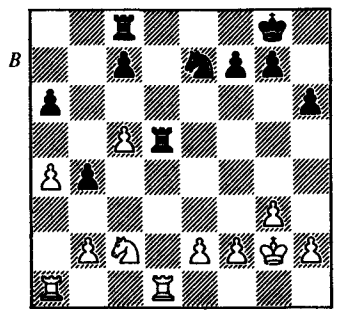
the bishop protected with ... ♗a8.

20	**♗xe7**	*1.16*	**♕xe7**	*1.38*
21	**♕c5**	*1.42*		



A decision which was greeted by universal surprise, since White abandons his ambitions on the c-file. However, if 21 b4 Black can either react with ... a5 or ... ♘b6, in both cases with counterplay. Nevertheless, White may still enjoy an infinitesimal edge after 21 b4 a5 22 ba c5 23 ♕b2!

21	...		**♕xc5**	*1.41*
22	**dc**	*1.42*	**♘e7**	*1.41*
23	**a4**	*1.42*	**b4**	*1.43*
24	**♘d4**	*1.54*	**♗xg2**	*1.44*
25	**♔xg2**	*1.54*	**♖fd8**	*1.45*
26	**♖fd1**	*1.54*	**♖d5**	*1.46*
27	**♘c2!**	*1.58*		



Deceptive passivity, as after 27 ... ♖xc5 28 ♘xb4 a5 29 ♘d3 ♖c2 30 ♔f1 followed by ♖ac1 White still has the advantage. The whole key to White's strategy is that Black's b4 pawn is weaker than White's on c5. If White can force the concession ... a5 with knights still present, then an eventual ♘c4 will be really embarrassing.

27	...		**♖b8**	*1.59*
28	**♖xd5**	*1.58*	**♘xd5**	*1.59*
29	**♘d4**	*2.00*	**♘e7**	*2.00*
30	**♖d1**	*2.12*	**♔f8**	*2.06*

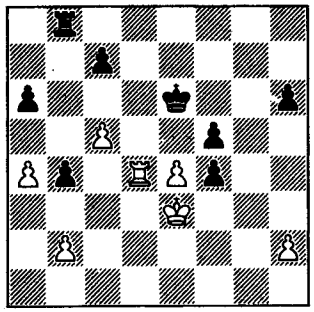
Coming across to defend the d-file from rook penetration. If 30 ... ♖d8 31 ♖d2 e5 32 ♘b3 ♖xd2 33 ♘xd2 the knight and pawn ending is still uncomfortable for Black. White's king will be more active, and there is a fine square on c4 for his knight.

31	**♘b3**	*2.13*	**♘c6**	*2.07*
32	**f4**	*2.13*	**♔e7**	*2.11*
33	**♔f3**	*2.13*	**g6**	*2.14*
34	**♖d2**	*2.20*	**f6**	*2.18*
35	**♔e4**	*2.21*	**f5+**	*2.21*
36	**♔d3**	*2.21*	**e5**	*2.21*

Just the correct moment for action – he makes a good square for his king on e6 and inaugurates a liquidation of the kingside pawns.

37	**e4**	*2.25*	**♔e6**	*2.25*
38	**♔e3**	*2.25*	**ef+**	*2.27*
39	**gf**	*2.26*	**g5**	*2.27*
40	**♘d4+**	*2.27*	**♘xd4**	*2.27*
41	**♖xd4**	*2.27*	**gf+** *(s)*	*3.05*

Draw Agreed



In this tail-end of a position the board has been virtually swept clean of pieces, but few people like to announce that nothing is going on. I tried to capture this air of muted hope when I wrote in the daily bulletin about the adjourned position: 'Kasparov sealed his 41st move. Candidate moves are 41 ... a5, playing possum, or liquidation with 41 ... gf+. The *Guardian* claims that White is still nominally better, while Grandmaster Shamkovich marginally favours Black's chances. The bulletin sticks its neck out and predicts a draw'.

game five
CATALECTIC

Kasparov took his time-out on 29 November, the day initially scheduled for Game 5, and during the respite he ordered up copies of the five-volume *ECO* set (Batsford/Informant: 'Encyclopaedia of Chess Openings') plus all four complete years of *MCT* ('Modern Chess Theory'). This surprised me, since these texts are standard kit for any player competing at international level and it seemed a strange oversight on the part of Gary's assistants to omit such essential items from their baggage.

The result of this redoubled expenditure of midnight oil was an intriguing psychological ploy – Gary abandoned the a3 anti-Queen's Indian line in favour of the Catalan. In other words, he used one of Viktor Korchnoi's own favourite weapons against the man himself. I remember that in 1977, when I was Korchnoi's second in the semi-final against Lev Polugayevsky, the Soviet grandmaster suddenly adopted the Catalan against Viktor. This made Viktor extremely angry, especially when Polugayevsky went too far by actually winning the game. Korchnoi became much more angry, in fact, than if he had just lost in an English Opening, or Bogo-Indian, for example.

In today's game the whole idea of taking up the Catalan simply misfired, and in spite of White's obtaining an optically favourable position the game rapidly fizzled out into premature and total equality. Another short draw with the white pieces must have been intensely depressing for Gary.

Kasparov-Korchnoi
Game 5, 1/12/83
Catalan

1	**d4**	*0.00*	♘**f6**	*0.00*
2	**c4**	*0.00*	**e6**	*0.00*
3	**g3**	*0.00*	**d5**	*0.00*
4	♗**g2**	*0.00*	**dc**	*0.00*
5	♘**f3**	*0.01*	**c5**	*0.00*

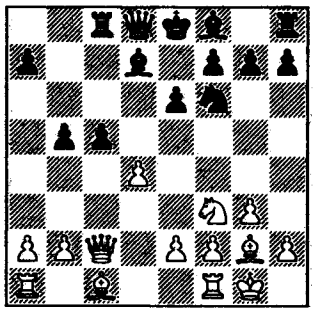
Hastening to liquidate the potentially backward c-pawn, which caused Black's minor pieces headaches in Game 4.

6	**0-0**	*0.02*	♘**bd7**	*0.01*
7	♘**a3**	*0.07*	♘**b6**	*0.01*

8 ♘xc4 *0.10* ♘xc4 *0.01*
9 ♕a4+ *0.10* ♗d7 *0.01*
10 ♕xc4 *0.10* **b5** *0.09*
11 ♕c2 *0.34*

11 ♕d3 would only encourage Black to establish a queenside pawn majority with ... c4.

11 ... **♖c8** *0.11*



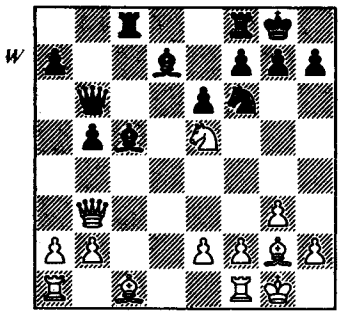
12 dc *0.44*

Eric Schiller's Catalan monograph recommends here 12 ♗g5 cd 13 ♕d3 ♗c5 14 ♘xd4 b4 15 ♘b3 ♗e7 16 ♖fd1 'with strong pressure', as in a game Shipman-Shapiro, New York 1983. Since Kasparov has a copy of Schiller's book he may have rejected this, believing his own continuation to be stronger. Alternatively, he may not have spotted the Shipman reference, since it is reached by a transpositional route in the Schiller text.

12 ... **♗xc5** *0.12*
13 ♕b3 *0.44* **0-0** *0.34*

Korchnoi utilised almost half an hour, probably trying to convince himself that White's coming effort to retain the initiative could be neutralised.

14 ♘e5 *0.46* ♕b6 *0.36*



15 ♗g5 *1.05*

The most obvious move, threatening to win a piece and break up Black's king's defences with ♗xf6. In the Press Room 15 ♘d3 was widely canvassed as more dangerous, but then 15 ... ♗c6! eliminates White's king's bishop and looks like a sufficient answer.

15 ... **♖fd8!** *0.36*

An instant and self-confident reply. Now 16 ♗xf6 gf 17 ♘xd7 ♖xd7 leaves Black too well centralised to be at all hampered by his fractured kingside.

16 ♕f3 *1.08* ♗e7 *0.37*
17 ♘xd7 *1.08* ♖xd7 *0.38*
18 ♖ac1 *1.08* ♖cd8 *0.47*

Again, Korchnoi's control is a perfect counterweight to White's bishop pair, which has very little to bite on. It is interesting to note that many of Black's problems in the Catalan evaporate if he can shift his b-pawn away from b7, i.e. from the direct line of fire of White's fianchettoed king's bishop.

19 ♕c6 *1.16* ♕a5 *0.49*

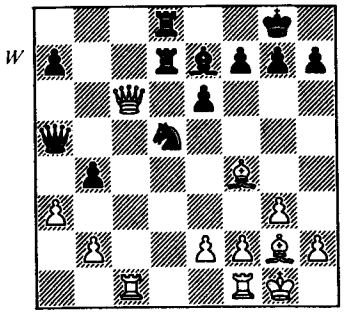
Of course, he must not exchange queens yet and let the white king's bishop reach c6.

20 a3 *1.37* **b4** *1.03*

Attacking the bishop on g5 and forcing equality.

21 ♗f4 *1.40* ♘d5 *1.10*

The game was agreed drawn. 22 ♗xd5 ♕xd5 leads to dead equality.



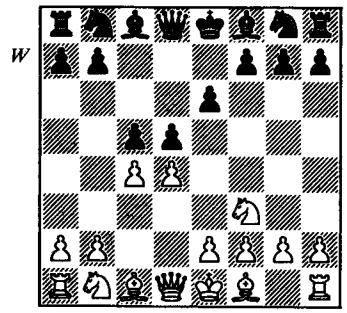
game six
KASPAROV CATCHES UP

Another Tarrasch from Kasparov instead of the King's Indian or Benoni for which many spectators have been hoping. Black's position in a queenless middlegame looked fairly sterile. Indeed, Black offered at least one draw, as far as our watches could tell, but Korchnoi resisted all temptations to split the point. Whether this was wise is an open question since excessively vigorous play by White in the late 20's led him into an ending with an extra exchange but under heavy threats from Black's passed pawns. In the adjourned position Kasparov sealed his 41st move.

The initial impression about the adjourned position was that Korchnoi was in desperate trouble. However, later more sober analysis indicated that the likely result would be a draw. It must be said that most of the spectating grandmasters found several moves from both sides in this game quite incomprehensible, and the general feeling was that Korchnoi missed more than one chance to salvage half a point. On the whole, this was a game which Korchnoi lost, not one which Kasparov won.

Korchnoi-Kasparov
Game 6, 4/12/83
Tarrasch Defence

1	**d4**	*0.00*	**d5**	*0.00*
2	**c4**	*0.00*	**e6**	*0.00*
3	**♘f3**	*0.00*	**c5**	*0.01*



Readers who are not experienced chess theoreticians may be interested in a little chess history at this point: Black's defence here, and also in Game 2, is named after the famous German grandmaster Dr Siegbert Tarrasch, who claimed that 3 ... c5'!' was the only correct defence to the Queen's Gambit. In the early 1890's he was probably the world's best player, but carelessly failed to contest a match with the incumbent Steinitz. When he did get round to taking time off from his doctor's practice in 1908 he was thoroughly trounced by Lasker and at this point his world title aspirations ceased. The ubiquitous Eric Schiller is also writing a book on this opening, in collaboration with Grandmaster Leonid Shamkovich.

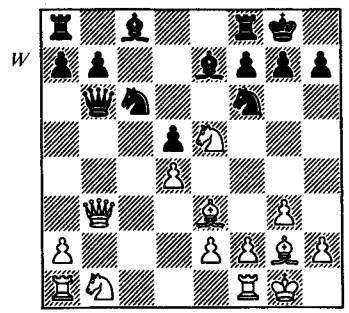
4	**cd**	*0.00*	**ed**	*0.01*
5	**g3**	*0.00*	**♘c6**	*0.02*
6	**♗g2**	*0.00*	**♘f6**	*0.02*
7	**0-0**	*0.00*	**♗e7**	*0.02*
8	**♗e3**	*0.01*		

A very unusual move which virtually forces Black's reply.

8	**...**		**c4**	*0.05*
9	**♘e5**	*0.01*	**0-0**	*0.06*
10	**b3**	*0.13*		

The first move of Korchnoi's which required any thought. It's quite natural to challenge Black's advanced pawn, though 10 ♘c3 (Miles-Petursson, Reykjavik 1980) also comes into consideration.

10	**...**		**cb**	*0.07*
11	**♕xb3**	*0.13*	**♕b6**	*0.58*



Much time spent on this, which is a new move. 11 ... ♘a5 12 ♕a4 is known and is not very comfortable for Black.

12	**♖c1**	*0.43*	**♕xb3**	*1.06*
13	**ab**	*0.44*	**♘b4**	*1.07*
14	**♘a3**	*0.50*	**a6**	*1.12*
15	**♗d2**	*0.53*	**♖b8**	*1.15*
16	**♗xb4**	*1.15*	**♗xb4**	*1.16*
17	**♘d3**	*1.15*	**♗d6**	*1.22*

Black's position is OK except for one respect: if White can manoeuvre his knights onto the correct circuit Black's d-pawn may drop off.

18	**♘c2**	*1.16*	**♗g4**	*1.31*
19	**♔f1**	*1.16*	**♗f5**	*1.38*
20	**♘c5**	*1.21*	**♖fc8**	*1.42*

Here Korchnoi spurned a draw offer, quite rightly, as it turns out, viewed from the standpoint of the position. Still, a further draw might have been quite demoralising for Kasparov, who has been, more or less, on the defensive throughout this match and quite unable to show the tactical ingenuity for which he is celebrated. Psychologically, Korchnoi has been imposing his will on the course of events by achieving simplified, technical positions, game after game.

21	**♘e3**	*1.33*	**♗e6**	*1.43*
22	**b4**	*1.36*	**♔f8**	*1.43*
23	**♖c2**	*1.38*	**♔e7**	*1.45*
24	**♔e1**	*1.44*	**h5**	*2.01*
25	**♖b2**	*1.57*	**♖c7**	*2.04*
26	**♘d3**	*1.58*	**♖a8**	*2.11*
27	**b5**	*2.04*		

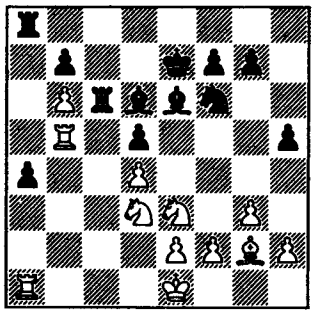
A highly committal move. The plan is to surround Black's d-pawn but the drawback is that Black immediately obtains a passed

pawn. 27 ♘f4 is simple and strong.

27 ... **a5** *2.12*
28 **b6** *2.04* **♖c6** *2.13*
29 **♖b5** *2.10*

29 ♘f4 is very strong here too.

29 ... **a4** *2.13*



What White plays now is a total mental aberration which wrecks his game. After 30 ♘c5 or 30 ♘f4 White is clearly on top.

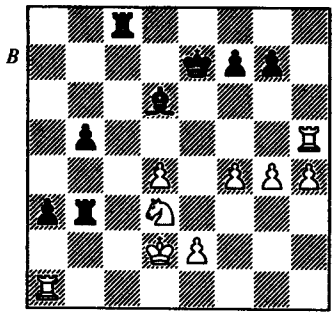
30 **♘xd5+** *2.14* **♘xd5** *2.14*
31 **♗xd5** *2.14* **♗xd5** *2.14*
32 **♖xd5** *2.14* **♖xb6** *2.14*
33 **♖xh5** *2.14*

This capture seems irrelevant. Korchnoi's second Van der Wiel suggested instead 33 e4, though the damage has already been substantially done. Black's united passed pawns are now the major factor.

33 ... **♖b3** *2.19*
34 **♔d2** *2.22* **b5** *2.19*
35 **h4** *2.24* **♖c8** *2.20*
36 **g4** *2.26* **a3** *2.21*

When he played this move Gary, in his excitement, accidentally knocked his hammer and sickle flag to the ground.

37 **f4** *2.27*



Looks loosening, but White just doesn't have a constructive move at his disposal until Black pushes his b-pawn to b4.

37 ... **♖cc3?** *2.23*

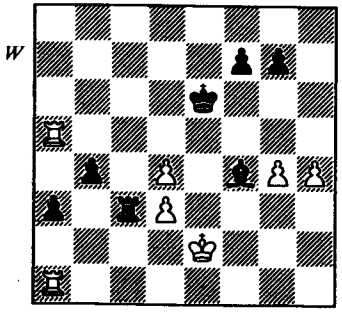
Kasparov retrieved his flag and screwed the pole back into the base. Possibly he was distracted by this since 37 ... ♖c4! wins easily.

38 **♖d5** *2.27* **♔e6** *2.25*
39 **♖h5** *2.28* **b4** *2.26*
40 **♖a5** *2.28* **♖xd3+** *2.28*
41 **ed** *2.28*

Black sealed his 41st move.

The second session was on 5/12/83.

41 ... **♗xf4+** *2.32*
42 **♔e2** *2.28* **♖c3!** *2.32*



The most dangerous. Korchnoi's seconds complained to me that they had mostly analysed 42 ... ♖b2+.

43 **g5** *2.28*

Unexpected, and not least by Kasparov, who now spent 15 minutes on his reply. My impression was that 43 ♔f3 would draw, e.g. 43 ... ♗d6 44 ♔e4 ♔d7 45 ♔d5 and Black can make no progress. When I mentioned this variation to Korchnoi's second Van der Wiel, he said that White could still have difficulties and that Korchnoi's choice was best, though he did not back this up with precise variations.

43 ... **♗c1** *2.47*
44 **h5** *2.29* **b3** *2.47*

Van der Wiel also told me that Korchnoi's team underestimated this pawn push, thinking the rook ending easily drawn.

45 **♖5xa3** *2.39* **♗xa3** *2.49*
46 **♖xa3** *2.39* **b2** *2.51*
47 **♖a6+** *2.39* **♔f5** *2.51*
48 **♖b6** *2.39*

If 48 ♖a5+ Black wins with 48 ... ♔f4 (rather than 49 ... ♔g4), when he has the threat of ... ♖c2+ driving White's king back.

48 ... **♖c2+** *2.54*
49 **♔e3** *2.51* **♔xg5** *2.55*
50 **d5** *2.52*

If 50 ♖b5+ f5 51 d5 ♔xh5 52 d6 Black wins with 52 ... ♖c5!

50 ... **♔xh5** *3.01*
51 **♔d4** *2.57*

In the bar, Igor Ivanov (USSR defector – now Canadian – a VK supporter) and Van der Wiel were watching the progress of the ending on the Acorn computer monitor. Here, in good spirits, they conspicuously began to assert to me that Korchnoi was now 'playing for a win'! This seemed odd, since he actually offered a draw at this moment (rejected of course), but draw offers don't show up on the screen. Of course not 51 d6? ♖c6!

51 ... **g5** *3.08*
52 **♖b8** *2.57* **g4** *3.14*
53 **d6** *2.58* **♖c6** *3.22*

It would be equally efficient to play ... ♖c8 at once.

54 **♔e5** *3.08*

54 ♔d5 would be met by 54 ... ♖c8!, when White's king has been tempted further away from Black's g-pawn.

54 ... **♖c5+** *3.22*
55 **♔f6** *3.08*

If 55 ♔d4 Black would play 55 ... ♖c8, reaching the same position as was possible on move 53. Korchnoi's 55th move should have been the best way to draw, although it was pretty heavily criticised by the spectators at the time.

55 ... **g3** *3.23*
56 **♖xb2** *3.19* **♖d5** *3.23*
57 **♔xf7** *3.32*

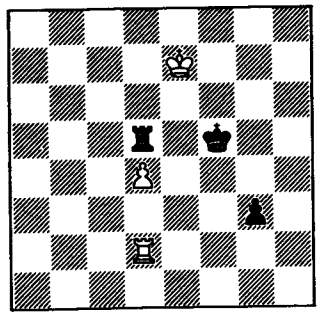
If 57 ♔e7 f5 and although White will win Black's rook the two connected passed pawns will win the game.

57 ... **♖xd6** *3.24*

58 ♖d2 *3.32* **♔g4** *3.34*
59 d4 *3.32* **♔f5** *3.34*

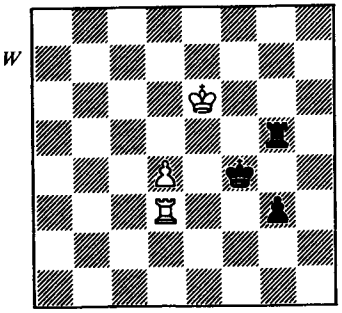
An excellent move which keeps White's king boxed in.

60 ♔e7 *3.44* **♖d5** *3.39*



During the game I could see no defence to 60 ... ♖g6, but White draws with 61 ♖g2 ♔e4 62 ♔f7 ♖g4 63 ♔e6! and although White will lose his rook he retains his passed d-pawn which will force Black to sacrifice his own rook in turn.

61 ♖d3 *3.45* **♔f4** *3.40*
62 ♔e6 *3.45* **♖g5** *3.41*



63 d5?? *3.52*

After this move Kasparov visibly breathed a sigh of relief. 63 ♖d1! draws in exactly the same way as given in the previous note. This horrible blunder was the turning point in the match. After it Korchnoi seemed unable to regain his composure for the following games.

63 ... **♖g6+** *3.42*

Now Black has a forced win.

64 ♔e7 *3.52* **g2** *3.43*
65 ♖d1 *3.52* **♔e5** *3.43*

If 65 ... g1♕ 66 ♖xg1 ♖xg1 67 d6 ♔e5 68 d7 ♖g7+ 69 ♔e8 ♔e6 70 d8♘+ draws.

66 d6 *3.54* **♖e6+** *3.43*
67 ♔d7 *3.54* **♖xd6+** *3.43*
68 ♖xd6 *3.54* **g1♕** *3.43*

The queen v rook position is an easy technical win. The remaining moves were:

69 ♖e6+ *3.54* **♔f5** *3.44*
70 ♖d6 *3.54* **♕a7+** *3.45*
71 ♔d8 *3.55* **♔e5** *3.51*
72 ♖g6 *3.55* **♕a5+** *4.06*
73 ♔d7 *3.58* **♕a4+** *4.11*
74 ♔e7 *4.03* **♕h4+** *4.12*
75 ♔f8 *4.04* **♕d8+** *4.14*
76 ♔f7 *4.04* **♔f5** *4.15*
77 ♖h6 *4.05* **♕d7+** *4.15*

Korchnoi resigned. US GM Walter Browne once experienced a certain degree of trouble winning queen v rook against the Belle computer, but the position was by no means as favourable as this one.

Mail on Sunday

Off-board excitement was caused today by the appearance of an article in the *Mail on Sunday* which erroneously identified Valentina Fominikh (the charming Russian translator) as a KGB agent and myself as the man who fixed the finances in Moscow. On top of this, the sums reputedly paid in compensation for the non-match in Pasadena were written up at an unrealistically high level. It was rather annoying for us to have attracted this kind of inaccurate reporting, but the sudden surge of media representatives searching for more details did provide welcome publicity.

game seven
CATALEPTIC

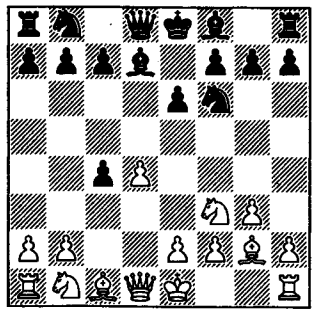
For the first time in this match Gary Kasparov is in the lead. The opening looked like another fairly quiet version of the Catalan. Indeed, after 12 moves, Grandmaster Robert Byrne, the *New York Times* chess correspondent, said to me that the position looked quite equal. However, with 16 b4! Kasparov dealt a hammer-blow to Black's queenside, from which Korchnoi was never able to recover. A curious feature of the game was that Korchnoi used up so little time. The likely explanation is that his prepared opening totally misfired, so after Korchnoi played the opening moves rapidly the turning point came suddenly and there was little real defence possible thereafter. This is, of course, conjecture. Another plausible ground for Korchnoi's defeat was sheer exhaustion after the prolonged ending of Game 6. I spent much of this game watching events from the front row of the auditorium and it seemed to me that Korchnoi's eyes were sometimes involuntarily closing – in fact, he looked very drowsy indeed – about as stunned as Monty Python's infamous Norwegian Blue Parrot.

Kasparov-Korchnoi
Game 7, 6/12/83
Catalan

1	**d4**	*0.00*	♘**f6**	*0.00*
2	**c4**	*0.00*	**e6**	*0.00*
3	**g3**	*0.00*		

Another try with his opponent's favourite weapon.

3	**...**		**d5**	*0.00*
4	♗**g2**	*0.00*	**dc**	*0.00*
5	♘**f3**	*0.00*	♗**d7!?**	*0.00*



According to all published annals, this is a new move, but Najdorf vociferously claimed in the Press Room that he had played it 50 years ago! Korchnoi was probably right to be suspicious of his defensive method from Game 5.

6	♕**c2**	*0.20*		

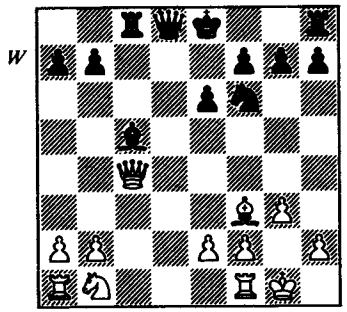
If 6 ♘e5 ♗c6!

6	**...**		**c5**	*0.01*
7	**0-0**	*0.24*	♗**c6**	*0.01*
8	♕**xc4**	*0.29*	♘**bd7**	*0.02*
9	♗**g5**	*0.35*	♖**c8**	*0.07*
10	♗**xf6**	*0.40*	♘**xf6**	*0.27*

Or 10 ... ♕xf6 11 ♘c3 threatening d5.

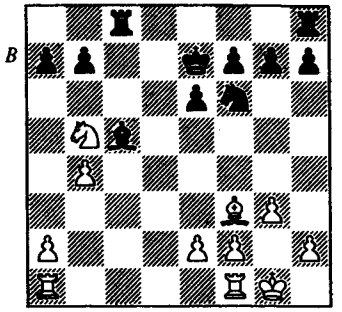
11	**dc**	*0.42*	♗**xf3**	*0.30*
12	♗**xf3**	*0.42*	♗**xc5**	*0.30*

With the tactical threat of ... ♗xf2+ and ♖xc4.



Strategically, Black has accomplished everything which he should, in theory, strive for in the Catalan. First of all, he has liquidated the central pawns, then he has achieved near parity in development and finally he has established an opposite bishop situation, which normally facilitates a drawn outcome. The only problem he faces is the slight exposure of his b7 pawn to White's king's bishop operating along the a8-h1 diagonal.

13	♕**b5+**	*0.49*	♕**d7**	*0.31*
14	♘**c3**	*0.56*	♕**xb5**	*0.35*
15	♘**xb5**	*0.56*	♔**e7**	*0.35*
16	**b4!**	*1.04*		



Without this excellent move White would have nothing. 16 ♗xb7 ♖b8 only gets White's minor pieces into a hopeless tangle.

16	**...**		♗**xb4**	*0.41*
17	♘**xa7**	*1.04*	♖**c7?**	*0.44*

After this careless error Black is lost, since he cannot defend his exposed b7 pawn. The only resistance lies in 17 ... ♖a8 18 ♘b5 ♖fb8 20 ♖fc1 ♘e8!. 17 ... ♖a8 18 ♖fb1 ♖xa7 19 ♖xb4 is also better for White.

18	♖**fc1**	*1.07*	♖**d7**	*0.47*
19	♖**ab1**	*1.10*	♗**d2**	*0.57*

Now if 19 ... ♖a8? just 20 ♘c8+ wins.

20	♖**c2**	*1.10*	♖**hd8**	*0.59*
21	♗**xb7**	*1.12*	♔**f8**	*0.59*
22	♘**c6**	*1.13*	♖**c7**	*1.00*
23	♖**bb2**	*1.18*		

I really thought Viktor was going to resign, but he continued to find ingenious ways of not losing vast amounts of material.

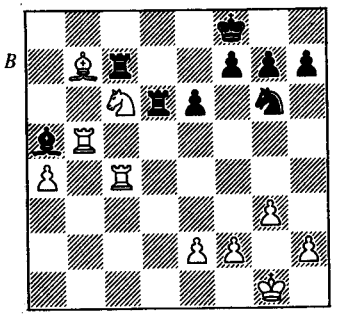
23	...		♖d6!	*1.01*
24	**a4**	*1.28*	♗e1	*1.01*
25	♖b1	*1.34*		

I thought at the time that 25 a5 would win more simply, but then counterplay arises in the shape of 25 ... ♘g4! 26 f3 ♘e3 27 a6?! ♖d1!

25	...		♘d5	*1.02*
26	♗a8	*1.47*	♖c8	*1.03*
27	♗b7	*1.47*		

Purely temporary hesitation. White's next is crushing.

27	...		♖c7	*1.03*
28	♖c4!	*1.49*	♘e7	*1.14*
29	♘e5	*1.51*	♗a5	*1.15*
30	♖b5	*1.55*	♘g6	*1.17*
31	♘c6	*2.00*		



After this Black can resign without qualms. There is a truly aesthetic quality to White's concentration of forces on the queenside light squares.

31	...		♖d1+	*1.18*
32	♔g2	*2.01*	♗e1	*1.18*
33	**a5**	*2.01*	♘e7	*1.19*
34	**a6**	*2.03*	♘xc6	*1.19*
35	♖xc6	*2.04*	♖xc6	*1.19*
36	♗xc6	*2.04*	♖a1	*1.19*
37	♖b8+	*2.05*	♔e7	*1.19*
38	♖b7+	*2.06*	♔d6	*1.19*
39	♗b5	*2.06*	♗c3	*1.19*
40	♖xf7	*2.07*	♗f6	*1.20*
41	♖d7+	*2.08*	♔c5	*1.20*
42	♗d3	*2.08*	**h6**	*1.20*
43	♖b7	*2.09*	♖a3	*1.22*
44	**a7**	*2.10*	♔d5	*1.23*
45	**f3**	*2.11*	♔d6	*1.24*
46	♖b6+	*2.12*		

and Black resigned

At the conclusion of the game the players did not hesitate to shake hands, continuing evidence of the high sporting regard in which they hold each other.

game eight
HOMAGE TO CATALONIA

Yet another Catalan opening! Is it because we are fast approaching 1984 or an act of deference to Antonio Medina, Chief Arbiter in the parallel Ribli-Smyslov match, who is a native of that region of Spain? The most likely answer is that both Kasparov and Korchnoi are temporarily disillusioned with White's prospects in the more direct main lines, such as the Queen's Indian, Nimzo-Indian and Orthodox Queen's Gambit. Ironically, what we now call the Catalan is a kind of misnomer, since its original introduction, by the Polish grandmaster Tartakower at Spanish events in the late 1920s and early 1930s, did not envisage use of the move c4. Tartakower's concept was to hold back the white c-pawn, either on c2 or c3, and aim for e4, by means of ♘bd2, ♖e1 and then the desired central thrust.

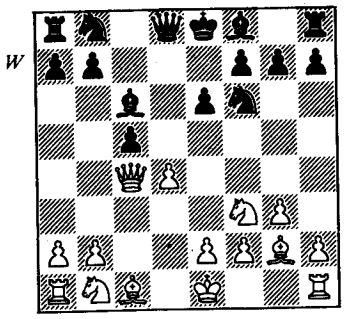
In Game 8 Kasparov's defensive method looked similar to that chosen by Korchnoi in their previous encounter – the difference was that Gary gained a useful development tempo by briefly sacrificing a pawn. The resultant simplification led to an apparent wilderness from White's point of view. Indeed, Kasparov's youthful confidence in the impregnability of his position could hardly have been overlooked by the crowd. (Gary is one of the least inscrutable players I know – he would be terrible at poker.) At this point, Korchnoi demonstrated what a great master he is of nearly equal positions and proceeded to build up tangible pressure, based on the latent power of his g2 bishop. On move 24, however, he went astray, transposing into a drawish knight ending, instead of keeping up the tension with ♖c5!. Near adjournment, Gary offered a draw, in English, which Viktor accepted by smiling broadly and pushing his scoresheet across the table for Gary's signature.

Sometimes I cannot suppress feelings of disbelief at the staging of this match in London. Having witnessed first hand Korchnoi's hatred of Karpov at Baguio and

afterwards been accused myself of being a Soviet agent by the disappointed loser, here I am, as impartial Chief Organiser of a match between the self-same Korchnoi and a Russian GM. Each day I see them on personal terms of comparative sweetness and light. Perhaps *Gens Una Sumus*, FIDE's motto, really does conceal a basic truth about human nature.

Korchnoi-Kasparov
Game 8, 10/12/83
Catalan

1	**d4**	*0.00*	**d5**	*0.00*
2	**c4**	*0.00*	**e6**	*0.00*
3	**♘f3**	*0.01*	**♘f6**	*0.00*
4	**g3**	*0.01*	**dc**	*0.00*
5	**♗g2**	*0.01*	**c5**	*0.00*
6	**♕a4+**	*0.06*	**♗d7**	*0.01*
7	**♕xc4**	*0.06*	**♗c6**	*0.01*



8 dc *0.08*

White could transpose into Game 7 here with 8 0-0 ♘bd7?! 9 ♗g5 etc, but it's more sensible to start exchanges with 8 ... cd!

8	**...**		**♘bd7**	*0.02*
9	**♗e3**	*0.10*		

If 9 b4? a5 10 b5 ♗d5 leaves White's queenside pawn structure in ruins.

9	**...**		**♗d5**	*0.06*

A new move. In *ECO* Averbakh, here in London as Smyslov's second, suggests 9 ... ♘d5!? to harass the white bishop on e3.

10	**♕a4**	*0.17*	**♗c6**	*0.07*
11	**♕c4**	*0.35*	**♗d5**	*0.08*
12	**♕b4**	*0.35*		

Having taken time-out the day before, a refreshed Korchnoi, one point down, with White, will obviously not take a 12-move draw.

12	**...**		**♕c8**	*0.37*
13	**♘c3**	*0.37*	**♗xc5**	*0.38*

13 ... ♘xc5 looks like a sharp idea, since it embodies the threats of ... ♘d3+ and ♘b3, winning material. However, it backfires after 14 ♘xd5! ♘d3+ 15 ed ♗xb4+ 16 ♘xb4, with too much for the queen.

14	**♗xc5**	*0.38*	**♕xc5**	*0.38*
15	**♘xd5**	*0.39*	**♘xd5**	*0.39*
16	**♕d2**	*0.52*		

Excellent. 16 ♕xc5 ♘xc5 just helps Black. Now White will gain time with ♖ac1.

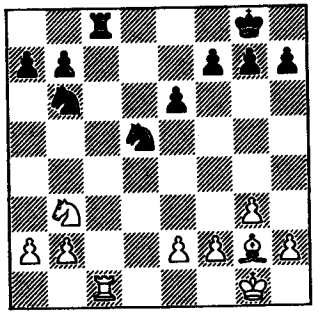
16	**...**		**♖c8**	*0.51*
17	**0-0**	*0.54*	**0-0**	*0.51*

17 ... ♕c2?! 18 ♖ac1 ♕xd2 19 ♖xc8+ ♔e7 is good for Black, but 18 ♖fd1 0-0 19 ♖ac1 ♕xd2 20 ♘xd2 leaves White with the edge.

18	**♖ac1**	*0.57*	**♕b6**	*0.51*
19	**♕d4!**	*1.09*		

Displaying superb insight. This is just the right time to swap queens, since the white knight, coming to d4, has excellent perspectives at b5, or b3 and then c5. Hereabouts Gary started to look worried.

19	**...**		**♖fd8**	*1.01*
20	**♖fd1**	*1.11*	**♕xd4**	*1.23*
21	**♘xd4**	*1.11*	**♘7b6**	*1.24*
22	**♘b3**	*1.31*	**♖xc1**	*1.34*
23	**♖xc1**	*1.31*	**♖c8**	*1.39*



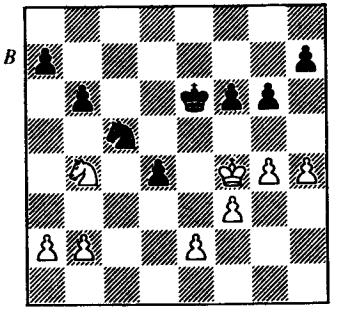
24 ♖xc8+ *1.42*

It is tempting to inflict an IQP on Black in the resultant knight ending, but the most dangerous move here is 24 ♖c5! when Black cannot exchange rooks. White has then the idea of ♖a5, encouraging ... a6, and then returning with the rook to c5. In this case, the black queenside pawns, now on a6 and b7, would form more of a target than in the game.

24	**...**		**♘xc8**	*1.39*
25	**♗xd5**	*1.48*	**ed**	*1.39*
26	**♘c5**	*1.49*		

More ambitious than the blockading 26 ♘d4, which gives a purely optical, symbolic plus. None of the spectating GMs felt that Black should have serious trouble holding on now.

26	**...**		**♘d6**	*1.45*
27	**♔g2**	*1.57*	**♔f8**	*1.51*
28	**♔f3**	*2.03*	**♔e7**	*1.51*
29	**♔f4**	*2.04*	**f6**	*1.54*
30	**h4**	*2.06*	**g6**	*2.04*
31	**g4**	*2.08*	**b6**	*2.05*
32	**♘a6**	*2.10*	**♘e4**	*2.08*
33	**f3**	*2.12*	**♘c5**	*2.09*
34	**♘c7**	*2.14*	**d4**	*2.15*
35	**♘d5+**	*2.17*	**♔e6**	*2.16*
36	**♘b4**	*2.18*		



36 ... a5 *2.18*

Forcing sterile equality. I had been expecting 36 ... h6!?, e.g. 37 h5 g5+ forcing White's king back, or 37 g5 fg+ 38 hg h5, with an outside passed pawn, or 37 ♘d3 g5+ 38 hg hg+ 39 ♔g3 ♔d5, and if anyone is better it is Black, but still doubtless drawn.

37	**♘d3**	*2.19*	**♔d5**	*2.18*
38	**g5**	*2.22*	**f5**	*2.20*
39	**♔g3**	*2.22*	**♘xd3**	*2.21*

Draw Agreed

game nine
CATALUNACY!

After inexplicably weak opening play from Korchnoi, Gary Kasparov moved into the happy position of needing one win, or two draws, to clinch the match in his favour. Korchnoi's defence looked like disastrously misanalysed preparation and by move 22 he was already completely lost. It is hard to understand how Kasparov is drawing relatively easily against the Catalan as Black, and winning quickly with it as White! Korchnoi's rueful comment to me after the end of play was: 'This game was lost at home'.

Kasparov-Korchnoi
Game 9, 12/12/83
Catalan

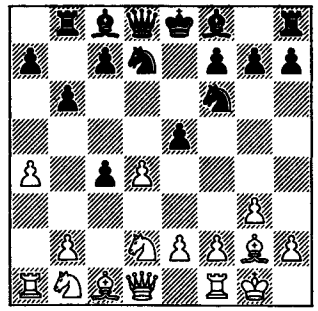
1	**d4**	*0.00*	**♘f6**	*0.00*
2	**c4**	*0.00*	**e6**	*0.00*
3	**g3**	*0.00*	**d5**	*0.00*
4	**♗g2**	*0.00*	**dc**	*0.00*
5	**♘f3**	*0.00*	**♘bd7**	*0.00*
6	**0-0**	*0.01*	**♖b8**	*0.00*
7	**a4**			

Introducing an excellent way of regaining the pawn. The only line known previously was 7 ♕c2 b5 8 ♘e5 ♘xe5 9 de ♘d7 10 ♗c6, as in Rogers-Peters, Los Angeles 1982.

7	**...**		**b6**	*0.01*

If Black persists in clinging to his booty with 7 ... a6 then 8 a5! b5 9 ab cb 10 ♗f4 with great advantage.

8	**♘fd2!**	*0.04*	**e5?!**	*0.01*



This seems quite out of place in the Catalan, but judging from the time used, it formed part of Korchnoi's preparation. 'I played a move I would not recommend to my friends', said Viktor afterwards.

9	**♘xc4**	*0.21*	**ed**	*0.02*
10	**♕xd4**	*0.22*	**♗c5**	*0.02*
11	**♕d3**	*0.23*	**0-0**	*0.21*

Up to here Korchnoi had used only two minutes, now he invested a further twenty. 10 ... ♗c5 was banged out quickly and must have been part of preparation, so why the hesitation now?

12	**♘c3**	*0.24*	**♗b7**	*0.33*
13	**♗xb7**	*0.45*	**♖xb7**	*0.33*
14	**♕f3**	*0.48*	**♕a8**	*0.53*

Hoping for a long-term queen swap.

15	**♗f4**	*0.50*	**a6**	*0.53*
16	**e4**	*1.13*	**♖a7**	*0.54*

Black is already totally contorted, and Press Room prophets were predicting doom and disaster.

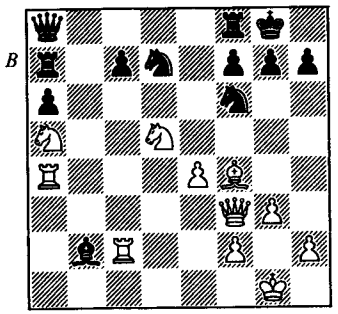
17	**♘d5**	*1.16*	**b5**	*0.56*
18	**♘a5!**	*1.30*		

Heading for c6.

18	**...**		**ba**	*1.10*
19	**♖fc1**	*1.31*	**♗d4**	*1.28*
20	**♖xa4**	*1.32*	**♗xb2**	*1.35*

Or 20 ... c5 21 ♘e7+ ♔h8 22 ♘ec6+.

21	**♘e7+**	*1.34*	**♔h8**	*1.35*
22	**♖c2**	*1.34*		



Absolutely crushing. Black cannot avoid heavy material loss, e.g. 22 ... ♗e5 23 ♘ec6 ♗xf4 24 gf, trapping Black's rook.

22	**...**		**♕e8**	*1.51*
23	**♖xb2**	*1.36*	**♕xe7**	*1.53*
24	**♘c6**	*1.36*	**♕c5**	*1.53*
25	**♘xa7**	*1.37*		

25 e5 might be even better.

25	**...**		**♕xa7**	*1.53*
26	**e5**	*1.37*	**♘g8**	*1.53*
27	**♗e3**	*1.49*	**♕a8**	*1.54*
28	**♕xa8**	*1.50*	**♖xa8**	*1.54*
29	**f4**	*1.50*	**♘e7**	*1.54*
30	**♖d2**	*1.51*		

and Black resigned

Part of Korchnoi's problem must be that he simply cannot see a way for Black to equalise in the Catalan, hence his resorting to eccentric and inadequate byways. This still does not explain why Kasparov is defending more easily with Black than he is. When I was Viktor's second, one of his overriding anxieties was that the openings chosen by himself and his opponent would 'cross'. All of his worst fears in this respect are being confirmed in the Catalan nightmare in which he now finds himself.

ten
SHORT CUT

One theory expounded by Korchnoi is that his opponent likes 'short games'. If he stands worse, Korchnoi explained, Kasparov likes to force equality quickly, and if he stands better, he likes to win as rapidly as possible. This is quite consistent, in fact, with Viktor's 'one big punch' comment cited earlier. Part of Viktor's psychology, therefore, has been to involve Kasparov in very long games. This backfired in Game 6, but today's game at first appeared promising for this strategy. A trench warfare position developed, where it was felt that Korchnoi could play on for hours and hours. Against most opponents this would doubtless have occurred, but rather than grimly defend Kasparov struck back with an amazing pawn sacrifice based on his 27th and 29th moves. Lightning briefly flashed across the board, for a move Kasparov was lost, then the smoke dispersed and only a dead drawn ending remained.

In spite of its flaws, this was the most exciting game of the match so far, and one where Korchnoi only just failed to reduce Kasparov's lead to a minimum.

Korchnoi-Kasparov
Game 10, 14/12/83
Queen's Gambit Tartakower

1	**d4**	*0.00*	**d5**	*0.00*
2	**c4**	*0.00*	**e6**	*0.00*
3	**♘f3**	*0.00*	**♘f6**	*0.00*
4	**♗g5**	*0.00*		

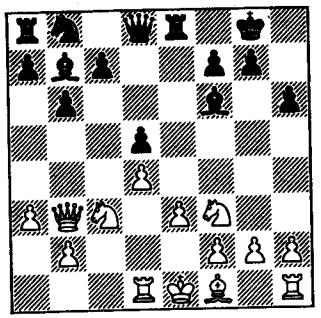
At last abandoning the Catalan.

4	**...**		**♗e7**	
5	**♘c3**	*0.00*	**h6**	*0.02*
6	**♗h4**	*0.00*	**0-0**	*0.02*
7	**e3**	*0.00*	**b6**	*0.04*

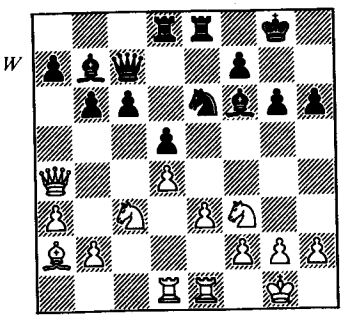
Kasparov, to the best of my knowledge, has never used this defence before, though significantly it is one of Karpov's favourites.

8	**♕b3**	*0.01*	**♗b7**	*0.04*
9	**♗xf6**	*0.01*	**♗xf6**	*0.04*
10	**cd**	*0.01*	**ed**	*0.04*
11	**♖d1**	*0.01*	**♖e8**	*0.06*
12	**a3**	*0.02*		

A new move probably, though Korchnoi adopted a similar plan in Game 11 of his match v Spassky at Belgrade, 1977. This game was quoted in my notes to Game 3 of this match. The long term idea (and it is very long term indeed) is to line up White's queen and king's bishop along the a2-g8 diagonal, to exert pressure on Black's d5 pawn. If Black defends via ... c6, undermining will continue with b4-b5.



12	**...**		**c6**	*0.17*
13	**♗d3**	*0.20*	**♘d7**	*0.22*
14	**0-0**	*0.21*	**g6**	*0.31*
15	**♖fe1**	*0.31*	**♘f8**	*0.33*
16	**♗b1**	*0.33*	**♘e6**	*0.34*
17	**♗a2**	*0.36*	**♕c7**	*1.14*
18	**♕a4**	*1.14*	**♖ad8**	*0.57*



From a chess-philosophical point of view, this is a most interesting position. Black is fully developed, well co-ordinated and centralised, and he has the bishop pair, so how can White ever break this kind of defence? The two key threats are b4-b5 (as explained above) and e4, but opening up the centre runs the occupational hazard that Black's bishops may be activated.

19	**b4**	*1.17*	**♕b8**	*1.43*
20	**♕c2**	*1.20*	**♕c7**	*1.14*
21	**♗b3**	*1.28*	**♗g7**	*1.19*
22	**♕a2**	*1.29*	**a6**	*1.38*

Kasparov is prepared to sit tight and wait for White to declare his intentions, but he soon runs out of patience. For the moment, he must prevent b5.

23 ♖c1 *1.34*

Trying to play a long game? 23 a4, followed by b5 if possible, looks more positive. Perhaps Korchnoi was afraid of 23 a4 b5, which weakens c5 but fixes White's pawn on b4 as a possible endgame target for Black's king's bishop.

23	**...**		**♕b8**	*1.38*
24	**♘a4**	*1.35*	**♕a7**	*1.39*
25	**♘c3**	*1.45*	**♕b8**	*1.43*
26	**♖b1**	*1.51*	**♕d6**	*1.46*
27	**♖bd1**	*2.08*	**a5**	*1.57*

It is possible to play possum again with 27 ... ♕c7 or 27 ... ♕b8, but with Viktor running short of time (only 20 minutes left) Gary decides to complicate.

28 ba *2.09*

GM Jon Speelman was expecting

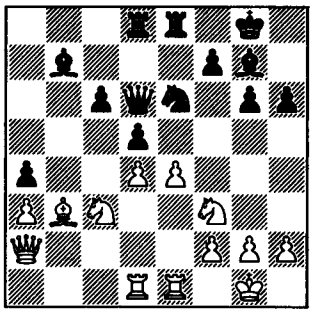
28 b5.

28 ... **ba** *1.59*

29 e4 *2.16*

A bold move when short of time. Korchnoi provokes a crisis, instad of playing circumspectly with 29 ♘a4.

29 ... **a4!?** *2.03*



A real Kasparov move, which sent everyone into shock. The solid 29 ... ♔h7 would be normal.

Some spontaneous comments on this move:

The worst move on the board – from a nervous Klara Kasparova (Gary's mother).

Gary's gone off his gourd – from Eric Schiller, 'Press Room Supremo'.

30 ♗xa4 *2.22* **de** *2.03*

31 ♘xe4 *2.24* **♕f4** *2.04*

32 d5 *2.26*

I was watching, and I saw that Korchnoi's hands were trembling at this point.

32 ... **♘d4**

I had been expecting 32 ... ♖xd5 33 ♖xd5 cd 34 ♗xe8 de with counterplay, or 34 ♘f6+ ♗xf6 35 ♗xe8 ♗c3 and then ... d4.

33 ♘xd4 *2.26* **♖xe4** *2.05*

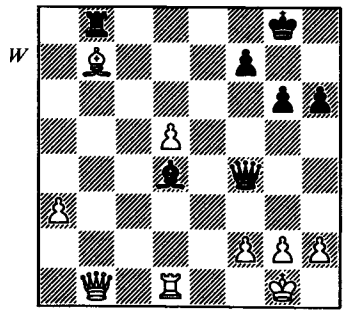
34 ♗xc6 *2.27* **♗xd4** *2.06*

35 ♖xe4 *2.28* **♕xe4** *2.06*

36 ♗xb7 *2.28* **♖b8** *2.07*

37 ♕b1 *2.28* **♕f4** *2.08*

White will play ♖b1 next move.



38 d6? *2.29*

Panic with his flag hanging. 38 ♕c2! unpins, defends f2 and meets 38 ... ♖xb7 with 39 ♕c8+ and ♕xb7. Checks on f2 are then harmless.

38 ... **♕xd6** *2.09*

39 g3 *2.29* **♖xb7** *2.12*

A neat combination which forces a drawn ending.

40 ♕xb7 *2.29* **♗xf2+** *2.12*

41 ♔xf2 *2.29* **♕xd1** *2.12*

42 ♕a8+ *2.32*

Draw Agreed

Viktor missed a great chance in this game, which was, nevertheless, the most exciting game so far.

eleven
JUST CAN'T STOP THE MUSIC!

When Kasparov is on top, he is almost impossible to stop. When he is ahead he does not resort to consolidation methods, but actually increases in energy, hence his habit of winning in the last round, even when half a point will suffice. This fate overtook Belyavsky in the quarter-final, and today Korchnoi trod the same path. Encouraged by the news that he has just been acclaimed as 'Young Sportsman of the Year' in Moscow, Gary marched straight through his opponent's defence to take the match by 7-4, the same result achieved by Karpov against Spassky in their 1974 semi-final.

I arrived for the game to be greeted by the news that a 'disco' was going to start up at 7.00 pm, right underneath the players. I succeeded in postponing this to 8.00 pm, and arranged for play to continue in a small private room if the noise should prove overwhelming. As it was, the strains of the disco did not penetrate until 8.30, just as Viktor was going down in a furious time-scramble. The last few moves were played to rock music accompaniment, but Viktor was too deaf and Gary too exultant to notice.

Kasparov-Korchnoi
Game 11, 16/12/83
Benoni

1 d4 *0.00* **♘f6** *0.00*

2 c4 *0.00* **e6** *0.00*

3 g3 *0.00* **c5** *0.00*

Korchnoi adopted a Benoni-style response against Karpov in the final game at Baguio 1978, while Belyavsky ran the identical risk in his final game v Gary (which he had to win) in Moscow earlier this year. Both times, Black lost. At least Viktor should receive full praise for his decision to exit with all guns blazing, rather than choosing a tame line, and then submitting to a draw.

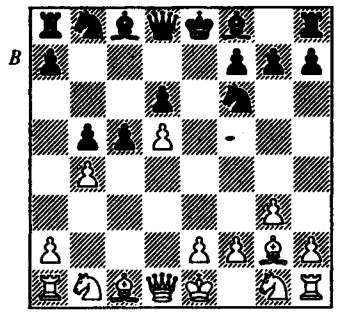
4 d5 *0.00* **ed** *0.00*

5 cd *0.01* **b5** *0.00*

6 ♗g2 *0.01* **d6** *0.01*

7 b4 *0.01*

Recently established as the best move against an ambitious Black formation which may well have



been suggested by Michael Stean, who used it to defeat Sosonko at Phillips & Drew 1980 – also a last-round game.

7 ... ♘a6!? *0.01*

A novelty, prepared at home, as can be seen from the time consumed. It improves on the well-known game Alburt-Ivanov, Kavkasian International, New York, October of this year. Here Black lost badly after 7 ... cb 8 a3 b3 9 ♕xb3 a6 10 a4. 8 ... ba 9 ♘xa3 ♕d7 10 ♕b3 is a promising gambit for White.

8	**bc**	*0.06*	**♘xc5**	*0.02*
9	**♘f3**	*0.06*	**g6**	*0.03*
10	**0-0**	*0.17*	**♗g7**	*0.06*
11	**♘d4**	*0.17*	**0-0**	*0.27*

Suddenly Korchnoi invests twenty minutes, after a prepared opening, and yet all of White's moves have been natural. This, to me, seems to indicate similar problems to those seen in the opening of Game 9.

12 ♘c3 *0.29*

If 12 ♘xb5 ♘fe4 13 ♘d4 ♗b7 14 f3 ♕b6! 15 ♗e3 ♕b2, or 15 ♔h1 ♘f6 16 e4 ♗a6. There is no necessity to allow Black this scale of counterplay.

12 ... a6 *1.03*

Thirty-six minutes spent on this, but now Black is probably lost. 12 ... b4 is the last chance to fight.

13 ♘c6 *1.00*

As in Games 7 and 9, the c6 square is Korchnoi's bane.

13	**...**		**♕c7**	*1.10*
14	**♗e3**	*1.02*	**♗b7**	*1.12*
15	**♗d4**	*1.03*	**♖fe8**	*1.20*
16	**a4!**	*1.11*		

Destroys Black's queenside.

16	**...**		**ba**	*1.24*
17	**♗xc5**	*1.15*	**dc**	*1.24*
18	**♕xa4**	*1.18*	**♘d7**	*1.35*
19	**♕b3**	*1.22*		

I had been expecting 19 ♖ac1 ♗xc3 20 ♖xc3 ♖xe2 21 ♘a5, with the threat of d6.

19	**...**		**♗xc6**	*1.43*
20	**dc**	*1.22*		

The powerful knight disappears, but the resultant passed pawn must guarantee victory.

20	**...**		**♘b6**	*1.43*
21	**♖ab1**	*1.23*	**♖ab8**	*1.51*
22	**♕a3**	*1.31*	**c4**	*1.56*
23	**♖fc1**	*1.33*	**♗xc3**	*2.06*

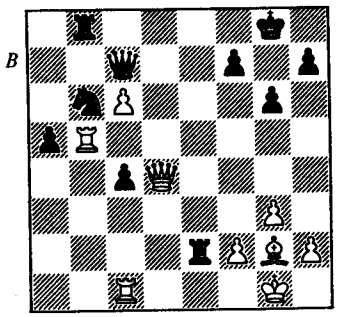
The only way to show any defiance is to grab White's e2 pawn.

24	**♕xc3**	*1.41*	**♖xe2**	*2.11*
25	**♕d4**	*1.41*		

A fine manoeuvre, which leaves Black without constructive moves. In lieu of such, he pushes his a-pawn.

25 ... a5 *2.14*

26 ♖b5 *1.52*



White has threats such as ♖cb1 or ♕f4, removing the blockade.

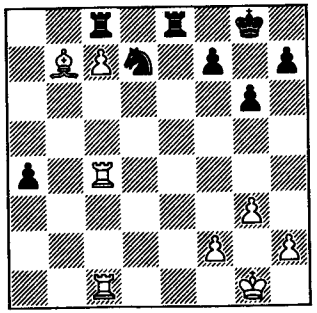
26	**...**		**a4**	*2.28*
27	**♗f3**	*1.53*	**♖e8**	*2.28*
28	**♕c5**	*1.54*		

28 ♖cb1 also wins material, but this is even more deadly. ♖cb1 still cannot be prevented, and meanwhile ... a3 is held up.

28 ... ♕e7 *2.28*

In desperate time trouble, Black collapses and voluntarily relinquishes his restraint of the c-pawn. Still, he had no adequate response to ♖cb1.

29	**c7**	*1.54*	**♕xc5**	*2.29*
30	**♖xc5**	*1.54*	**♖bc8**	*2.29*
31	**♗b7**	*1.54*	**♘d7**	*2.29*
32	**♖xc4**	*1.54*	**Resigns**	



I cannot suppress feelings of deep sympathy for Korchnoi. True, he seriously maligned me in his book 'Anti-Chess', written after Baguio 1978, but many of his accusations were so elephantinely outrageous that I eventually took the view that they were more laughable than actionable. In this match he has behaved as a perfect sportsman. Indeed, he could have legitimately expected an additional postponement for this game, since he was mugged while strolling on Tower Bridge the night before. There was no assault, just theft by some youths of the small case containing his Swiss passport. Still, definite grounds for an extra day off, had he wanted it.

Now, at age 52, he is out of the world cycle for another two years, and he will almost certainly never play another match for the world title. Usually he generates energy by resentment or hatred of his opponent. In London this was impossible. Kasparov was a mere child of thirteen when Korchnoi defected, and there are no political bones of contention between them. Indeed, in private Kasparov often refers to his erstwhile victim in the familiar mode: Viktor Lvovich.

As for Gary, pinned on the wall of his suite at the Great Eastern Hotel throughout the match were the words (in Russian):

If not you, then who else?

Conclusion

This match divides very clearly into two parts: from Game 1 up to the middle of Game 6, Korchnoi was in perfect control. He had driven Kasparov away from his pet a3 anti-Queen's Indian line, outclassed him in overall opening preparation, completely avoided his old foe, time pressure, and generally imposed his will on the whole proceedings.

Then, in Game 6, having constructed an imposing position, and declined an offer to split the point, Viktor went haywire, first missing a probable win, then throwing away an easy draw. Thereafter, Korchnoi collapsed, more or less without trace, and was overwhelmed in the second phase by the shattering score of 5-1.

For this key contest Kasparov abandoned his normal highly tactical approach and switched to positional strategy – much as Alekhine adapted against Capablanca in their 1927 marathon. One of the secrets of Gary's success was his espousal of Korchnoi's own terrain – the Catalan.

Why was this ploy so effective? Perhaps Viktor realises that objectively the most effective defences against the Catalan involve Black in tedious footwork in marginally inferior endings. Kasparov was prepared to suffer this when he was Black – Korchnoi was not. His attempts to launch surprise, unconventional anti-Catalan lines simply backfired.

We now look forward to a Kasparov-Smyslov final, followed, perhaps, by a Kasparov-Karpov world championship match, in the autumn of 1984. Is it too much to hope that part of that contest might also be sponsored in London?

KASPAROV	0	½	½	½	½	1	1	½	1	½	1		**7**
KORCHNOI	1	½	½	½	½	0	0	½	0	½	0		**4**